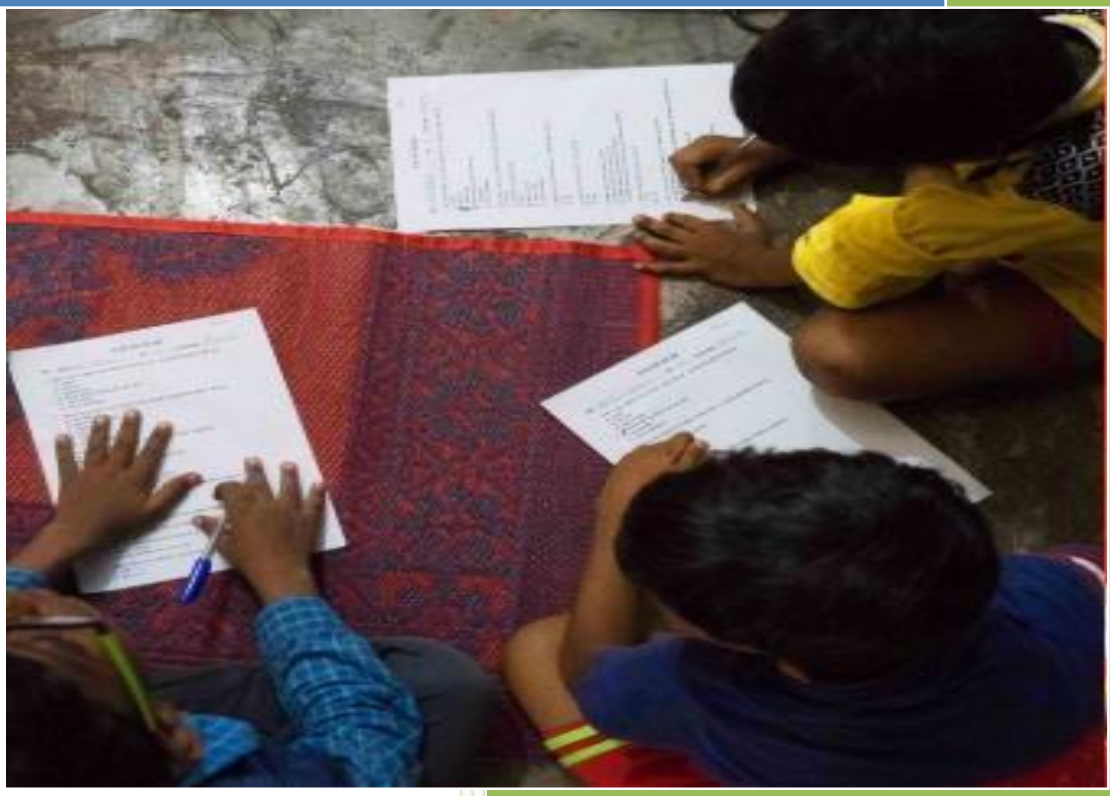
2021

SNEHA HR POLICY MANUAL



Dear Colleagues,

Our People philosophy and its two main cornerstones - "Transparency" and "Equity" - demand that we clearly define our HR policies and make them known to everyone within the organization. The HR Team has led this undertaking, and the HR Policies Manual is a result of this exercise.

The Policy Manual incorporates all HR policies and procedures and has been designed to provide ready information on the HR systems and processes as they impact the employees at SNEHA. These policies apply to all employees of SNEHA.

The Manual is expected to provide a comprehensive understanding of HR systems and procedures to all employees. It is also meant to establish the desired level of uniformity in the administration of these policies and practices. It will eliminate routine correspondence and ensure faster decision-making.

While the primary accountability for implementation of the Policies & Procedures lies with the Program/Domain Heads, the Human Resource Team is responsible for its administration, update and review. The HR Team will be more than happy to help in clarifying doubts.

The organization reserves the right to amend, alter and/or terminate any of the HR policies/procedures stated in this document at any time. This document supersedes any previous document on this subject.

Best Regards,

Ms. Naveen Shah
Director
HR Admin & Strategy Partnership

Vision, Mission & Values

Vision

Healthy Women and Children for a Healthy Urban World

Mission

We work in partnership with communities and health systems, building effective and replicable solutions and empowering women and their families in urban slums to improve their health.

Our Values

EXCELLENCE

We achieve excellence by consistently striving for quality through seeking the best in knowledge, practice and outcomes, while holding on to our values of discipline, adaptability and humility.

We believe that “Excellence is work’s real reward and not the glory it brings”.

COMMITMENT

We are dedicated to the work we do. It is seen through our passion, initiative and involvement.

TRUST

We believe in integrity, reliability, freedom and maintaining transparency.

NURTURE

We create an environment and provide opportunities for growth by constantly seeking and amplifying what works for the individual, the organization and the society we serve. We do this by focusing on strengths, guiding and mentoring individuals and communities and recognizing and appreciating efforts, thereby creating a supportive environment for growth.

VALUING EVERY PERSON

We respect every person, recognize individual strengths and capacities, believe in partnerships and embrace diversity.

SNEHA History

Dr. Armida Fernandez, founder for SNEHA and former dean of Lokmanya Tilak Hospital in Mumbai"s Sion district took a walk along the narrow winding streets of Dharavi, one of the largest slums in the world. What she saw, along with her 25 years of experience as a pediatrician and medical researcher, led to the birth of the Society for Nutrition, Education and Health Action, or SNEHA, meaning “affection” in Hindi.

“I started out with the vision of saving newborn lives because I saw so many children dying in Sion Hospital,” she recalled. “I said to myself that we have to stop this violence being faced by children and women. We had to work with the poor communities.”

Beginning then and continuing on to today, SNEHA works at the community level to empower people to become catalysts of change by collaborating with the existing public health systems and health-care providers to create sustainable improvements in urban health.

SNEHA Milestones

Human Resource Philosophy

We believe in

- Supporting program objectives and results
- Fostering human dignity by treating every employee fairly and with respect.
- Fostering diversity of people and thought
- Building constructive trusting relationships, individually and in teams
- Expecting, managing and rewarding quality performance.
- Fostering individual responsibility and accountability.
- Open, two-way employee communication
- Creating a work environment that is enjoyable for each of us.

SECTION I - RESOURCING

The following topics are covered in this section:

A) Resource Planning

B) Sourcing

C) Joining

D) Induction

E) Temporary Hiring

F) Rejoining

G) Hiring of Family Members

A) Resource Planning

I. Preamble:

Resource planning is conducted to forecast organization-wide people requirements for the coming year. It essentially entails program/domain plans, annual resource requirements for a program/domain and availability status within the organization. The outcome of this planning process is a structured roadmap of annual resource requirements, basis which the resourcing plan is devised.

II. Coverage:

All Programs and Domains in SNEHA.

III. Process:

- An **Annual Budget Exercise** is conducted towards the end of the year for the following year, during which people requirements of all programs and domains are forecast for the following year, resulting in a Resource Budget for the year, which is part of the overall program/domain budget.

- This forecasting exercise is in congruence with the projected program/domain plans for the year & involves a close interaction between the Program Directors/Domain Heads, Finance and HR.

- The Program Director/Domain Head, Finance & HR keep in mind the following points while developing the Annual Resource Budget for their respective Program/domains:
  - ⇒ The Organization Structure
  - ⇒ Program/Domain Plans
  - ⇒ Funding
  - ⇒ Identification of Resource requirements in terms of:
    - Roles
    - Skills
    - No of positions

B) Sourcing

I. Preamble:

People are the key differentiators & therefore the organization is committed to attracting, motivating & retaining people of the highest caliber & potential. The policy on sourcing is intended to provide the basis for a systematic and consistent approach to recruitment and selection in order to attract, select and retain capable & motivated staff as well as to ensure that appointments are based on merit through open competition and a fair and equitable selection process.

The Policy also seeks to integrate the profile of the employees being recruited with the organizations and programs" objectives as well as synchronize their fitment with the culture of the organization.

II. Recruitment Modes:

The organization uses any one or a combination of the following modes to fill vacancies:

- Internal Recruitment – Internal Job Postings/Transfers/Promotions
- Employee Referrals
- SNEHA Careers Website
- Job Portals
- Campus Recruitment
- Recruitment Agencies (only for selective senior positions)

The decision regarding the mode(s) is based on the following parameters:

- Skills available internally within the Organization
- Time period in which resources are required
- Profile (qualifications & experience) of the candidates required

III. Recruitment Process:

Recruitment is initiated after the **"Hiring Requisition Form"** has been filled & approved by the Program Director/Domain Head/Reporting Supervisor & the Finance Consultant. Additionally, for unbudgeted positions, Heads seek additional approval of the CEO.

3A. Recruitment Requisition:

Program Director/Domain Head/Supervisor send the "Hiring Requisition Form" to HR. The HR checks the Hiring Requisition Form for approvals and initiates the hiring process.

3B. Internal Recruitment:

The Organization views internal sourcing as a mechanism to provide opportunities to its employees to grow laterally & vertically within the organization. As such, before filling vacant position through external sources, attempts are made to ascertain if qualified & suitably experienced employees are available within SNEHA to fill the position through an **Internal Job Posting (IJP)** process.

3B1. IJP - Internal Advertising & Application Procedure:

3B1.1 HR posts all vacancies internally through Internal Job Posting. The job posting includes position, the program/domain hiring for & detailed job description. The job posting also includes the email ID where interested applicants can send their CV as well as the last date for receipt of applications.

3B1.2 HR screens the applications based on the following criteria:

a) Applicants must have completed at least one year in the current role
b) Applicants must be rated 3/4 in the last appraisal cycle
c) For a Director role, the applicant must have 12+ years of experience.
d) For Assistant Program Director and equivalent role, the applicant must have 8+ years of experience
e) For Program Coordinator and above roles, the applicant must be a Post Graduate
f) For Program Officer and equivalent, the applicant must be a Graduate

Exceptions to the above rule (if any) are approved by CEO.

3B2. Internal Selection Process:

3B2.1 An Interview Panel interviews all short-listed applicants. The Panel records its assessment of the applicants in the prescribed format and sends it to HR.

3B2.2 The selection process may also involve a skill-based test for certain positions.

3B2.3 Once the assessment and selection details are sent to HR, the selected employee is informed about his/her selection. The employee's Program Director/ Domain Head is simultaneously informed.

3B2.4 Applicants that have not been selected are informed the reasons for non- selection via a written mail from HR.

3B2.5 The salary of the selected employee is fixed keeping in mind the minimum-maximum salary band for that level.

3B2.6 The selected employee is given the offer, and the vacancy will be closed.

3B2.7 Employees can apply for any number of internal vacancies at a time if they meet the minimum specifications for these jobs. However, once they have been selected for a position and have accepted the offer, they are expected to serve at least for a year in their new position, before they can apply for any other internal positions.

3B2.8 The selected employee is required to move to the new role/position ideally within 30 days from the date of acceptance of offer OR in the timeframe as agreed by the current Program Director/Domain Head and new Program Director/Domain Head. This revised timeframe should not exceed 90 days from the date the applicant has been informed of his/her selection.

3B2.9 The date of joining for the new role/position is informed by HR to Finance for debiting cost to the new program/domain in the payroll.

3C. External Recruitment:

External Recruitment takes place through any one or a combination of the following modes.

- Employee Referrals
- E-recruitment (posting of vacancies on the SNEHA website "snehamumbai.org" and/or other job sites viz. „indeed.co.in" , „ naukri.com", „devnetjobsindia.org", etc.
- Campus Recruitment
- Recruitment agencies (for specific senior positions only)

3C1. External Recruitment Process Guidelines:

3C1.1 The vacancies are open externally if we do not find suitable applications internally. In some cases, the vacancy is simultaneously advertised internally and externally.

3C1.2 HR in consultation with the Program Director/Domain Head concerned shortlists the CVs on the basis of the Job Description & the Position specifications.

3C1.3 After the final screening, the shortlisted candidates are contacted by the HR. In case of agency candidates, the agency is informed of the shortlist for extending interview invitations.

3C1.4 HR in consultation with the hiring program/domain constitutes an interview panel which conducts interviews.

3C2. External Selection Process:

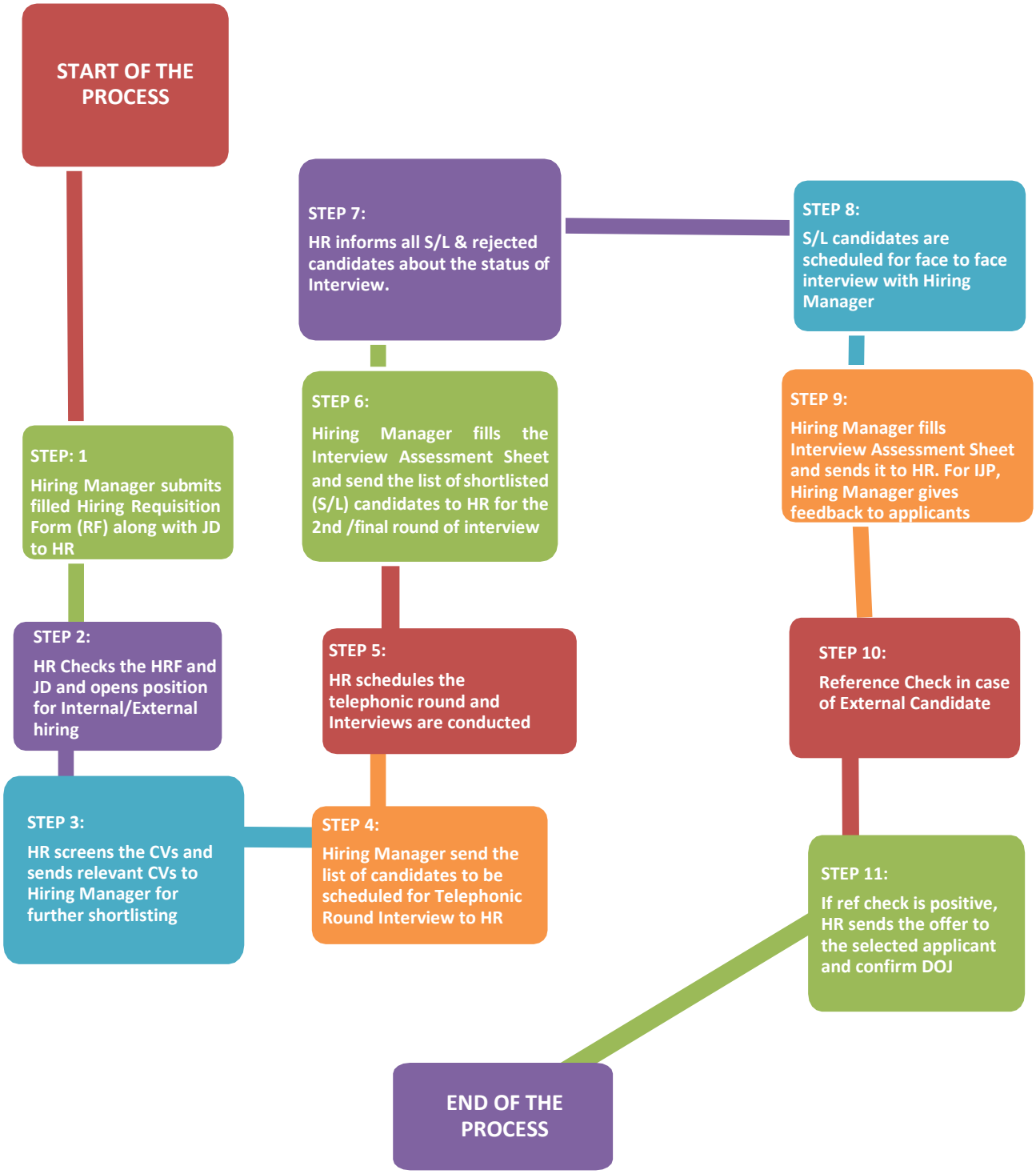
3C2.1 All shortlisted applicants are interviewed by an Interview Panel. The Panel will record its assessment of the applicants in the prescribed format and send it to HR.

3C2.2 The selection process may also involve a skill-based test.

3C2.3 The selected candidate is informed about his/her selection by HR.

3D. Interview Panel & Rounds of Interview and Process Flow:

Interview Panel Composition & Round of Interviews		
Roles	**Panel**	**Round of Interview (Including Telephonic Round)**
CEO / ED	Board of Trustees	Need Based
Director	CEO, ED, External Panelist, HR, Program Director of any other program	3
APD/ADD	CEO, ED, HR, Program/Domain Director	3
Coordinator and Equivalent	Program/Domain Director , APD/ADD, HR , External Panelist	3
Officer and Equivalent	Coordinator, APD/Domain Manager	2
Community Organizer and Equivalent	PO, Coordinator, APD/Domain Manager	2
Consultants	PD/APD/Domain Manager	2


START OF THE PROCESS
STEP: 1
Hiring Manager submits filled Hiring Requisition Form (RF) along with JD to HR
STEP 2:
HR Checks the HRF and JD and opens position for Internal/External hiring
STEP 3:
HR screens the CVs and sends relevant CVs to Hiring Manager for further shortlisting
STEP 4:
Hiring Manager send the list of candidates to be scheduled for Telephonic Round Interview to HR
STEP 5:
HR schedules the telephonic round and Interviews are conducted
STEP 6:
Hiring Manager fills the Interview Assessment Sheet and send the list of shortlisted (S/L) candidates to HR for the 2nd /final round of interview
STEP 7:
HR informs all S/L & rejected candidates about the status of Interview.
STEP 8:
S/L candidates are scheduled for face to face interview with Hiring Manager
STEP 9:
Hiring Manager fills Interview Assessment Sheet and sends it to HR. For IJP, Hiring Manager gives feedback to applicants
STEP 10:
Reference Check in case of External Candidate
STEP 11:
If ref check is positive, HR sends the offer to the selected applicant and confirm DOJ
END OF THE PROCESS

RECRUITMENT PROCESS FLOW

3E. Determination of Compensation:

Keeping in view the following, the HR determines the compensation:

- Minimum-Maximum salary band for the position
- Budget for the position
- Salaries of comparative position holders in the same program/domain & across program/domains with similar job profiles & experience.
- Criticality of skills & competencies
- Market potential

3F. Making an Offer:

- Selected candidates are verbally informed of their selection by HR
- The offer is emailed to the candidate.
- The offer is kept open for a period of 2 days and the selected candidates are asked to confirm their acceptance within the time period, failing which the offer is withdrawn & a second choice is activated.

3G. Reference Check:

Reference checks help us verify the claims made by applicants in their interview and help us make more informed hiring decisions.

HR conducts a Pre-Joining and Post-Joining reference check.

In both cases, the referee is a senior colleague/manager from the organizations he/she has worked with. For those fresh out of college, a reference check will not be conducted. In case a candidate has been on a break from work and does not have contact information of previous employer, a reference check will be conducted with any other professional reference provided by the candidate.

Steps for checking references

Step 1: Obtain referee details from the applicants

At the face-to-face interview stage, we ask applicants for referee details in a given format and get their permission to contact them in case they are selected.

Step 2: Pre-Joining Reference Check

Pre-joining reference check is done from the previous employer before an offer is made to the candidate. The Reference check will be conducted over the phone by HR. The HR team member conducting the check will ask a set of questions to the referee and will sign at the end of the document. Once HR is satisfied with the reference check, the offer will be made to the candidate. The reference check will be completed within two working days of candidate selection.

Step 3: Post-Joining Reference Check

Post joining reference check is conducted after the candidate joins and is conducted with the current employer. The reference check will be conducted over the phone or through email by HR. The HR team member taking reference will ask a set of questions to the referee and will sign at the end of the document. The post joining reference check will be one within one month of candidate joining.

Both pre and post joining reference check documents will be filed in the personal file of the new joinee.

Unsatisfactory Reference

In case an unsatisfactory reference is received during pre-joining, the program team will be informed and the PD/Directors decision to hire/not to hire the candidate will be final.

In case of unsatisfactory reference received post joining, the new joinee will be asked to provide a suitable explanation and the final call to retain the new joinee or terminate the services of the new joinee will rest with the PD/Directors and HR.

Unable to obtain Reference

In the following scenarios, it is possible that HR is unable to obtain professional reference check for the candidate/new joinee:

- Candidate/New Joinee unable to provide any references
- Company/Supervisor not responding to HR calls/emails
- Supervisor no longer with the same organization or is not willing to give reference
- The Company does not exist any longer
- Any other legitimate reasons

In such cases, HR will document the reason and will take a decision to hire/not hire the candidate/continue employment of the new joinee.

3H. Medical Examinations:

- Offered candidates have to undergo a Medical Examination organized by SNEHA post the candidate accepts the offer.
- The medical tests include CBC, ESR and Urine test conducted by our in-house doctors and lab technicians.
- Upon receiving a clear medical report, the candidate is fit to join the organization.
- In case the candidate does not meet health standards as per our doctors, the candidate is prescribed measures to improve their condition and return once the medical reports are cleared by the doctor.
- The doctor's recommendation is final in all cases.

C) Joining

I. Preamble:

This section covers the entitlements & procedures applicable to all employees upon joining services.

II. Process:

2.A The day the candidate joins the organization, HR sends a joining mail to relevant programs/domains informing them about the joining.

2.B HR hands over the appointment letter to the new joinee, issues ID cards and completes joining formalities.

III. Day 1 Orientation:

All new joinees undergo a 1st day orientation conducted by HR on the day of joining. The new joinee gets familiar with some critical HR policies and Peopleworks – our current HRIS system.

IV. Probation Period:

4A. A probation period of 3 months is mandatory for all employees. It commences from the date of joining the organization.

4B. During this period, new joinees have the opportunity to evaluate SNEHA as a place to work and the management has its first opportunity to evaluate the person. During this introductory period, both have the right to terminate the work agreement with a 7-day notice. A probation performance appraisal will be conducted after the said probation period is over to determine continuity/discontinuity of service.

V. Probation Appraisal & Confirmations:

5A. New joinees undergo a probation appraisal 3 months after joining SNEHA. The respective supervisor reviews and discusses performance at the end of the probation period with reference to clearly stated and agreed job objectives/goals/targets, general conduct and recommends continuation/discontinuation of service based on satisfactory performance on above parameters.

5B. If the supervisor feels that the new joinee needs some more time to settle down in SNEHA, then the probation period may be extended for a further period, up to a maximum of 3 months from the probation appraisal due date.

5C. If performance is satisfactory at the end of the probation period/extended probation period, the new joinee is confirmed in the services of the organization.

5D. The Supervisor fills the Probation Appraisal Form and sends it to HR, post which HR sends a confirmation letter to the new joinee.

5E. In case the new joinee does not successfully complete the probation period/extended probation period, HR issues a termination notice to the new joinee post discussion with the new joinee and the supervisor.

D) Induction

I. Preamble:

The Induction Policy aims to institutionalize a process by which all new employees joining SNEHA are able to view the organization correctly & uniformly i.e., the organization"s services, its people, its values, the systems & procedures besides having a better understanding of their role & relationships both within & outside the organization.

The induction policy also aims to make a new employee feel welcome in SNEHA & ensure his/her smooth transition into the SNEHA team for effective discharge of duties.

II. Coverage:

All new joinees joined in two months. (Bi-monthly)

III. Process:

FORTNIGHT PRIOR:

3A. HR informs Admin/Respective program/domains about the date & number of people joining to ensure requisite actions are performed by each department w.r.t. the new employees.

WEEK PRIOR:

3B. HR sends a mail to respective inductor(s) outlining available timeslots. Inductor(s) fill in the time slot most convenient to them.

3C. HR books a meeting room & intimates the final schedule to the inductor(s).

3D. HR prepares induction kits for all new employees, which are handed over on the day of joining. All new employees get the following:

- Policy Handbook

- Values PPT
- Prevention of Sexual Harassment at Workplace Policy

3E. On the day of induction, new employees assemble in a meeting room. A sample induction plan is given below.

Sample Induction Schedule

Date / Time	Activity	Inductor(s)	Areas to be covered
Day 1 10:30-13:00 Hrs.	Welcome to SNEHA	Capability Head	➢ Organization Overview ➢ SNEHA Values
13:00-14:00 Hrs.	Lunch		
14:00-18:00 Hrs.	Program/Domain Induction	Inductor	➢ About the Program/Domain ➢ Functions of various Program/Domain
Day 2 10:00-13:00 Hrs.	Program/Domain Induction	Inductor	➢ About the Program/Domain ➢ Functions of various Program/Domain
13:00-14:00 Hrs.	Lunch		
14:00-18:00 Hrs.	Program/Domain Induction	Inductor	➢ About the Program/Domain ➢ Functions of various Program/Domain
Day 3 10:00-13:00 Hrs.	POSH Orientation	Capability Head	➢ Orientation of POSH policy
13:00-14:00 Hrs.	Lunch		
14:00-17:00 Hrs.	HR Induction	Inductor from HR	➢ Policies related to HR ➢ Activities ➢ Closing session ➢ Feedback from the new joinees

E) Temporary Hiring

I. Preamble:

The organization engages with temporary staff for certain type of jobs/roles at various locations and centers of SNEHA for a specific period of time.

II. Eligibility Criteria/Coverage:

Temporary staff is hired primarily for (but not restricted to) the following positions:

- Consultants
- Helper/House Keeping
- Security Guard

Temporary staff can be hired primarily for (but not restricted to) the following reasons:

- Specific skills not currently available in the organization.
- Program/Domain requirements which are time-bound and delivery-based.
- Special assignments which are time-bound.
- Certain type of roles where we do not need full-time staff

F) Rejoining

I. Preamble:

Ex-employees can be permitted to rejoin the organization.

II. Eligibility Criteria & Coverage:

Ex-employees are eligible for rehiring subject to their separation meeting the conditions below:

- Where the person's performance record has been tracked as average/above average and his/her skills are still critical to the operations

  AND

- Where no disciplinary proceedings were ever initiated against the employee during his/her tenure with the organization.

III. Process:

- Should the ex-employee be eligible for rehiring, HR conducts further reference checks before initiating rehiring process. HR also seeks views of the Supervisors/ Program Director/Domain Head who have earlier worked with the ex-employee during the tenure of his/her service.

- Based on the results of the reference check & feedback, HR initiates hiring actions.

G) Hiring of Family Members/Relatives

I. Preamble:

The Organization does believe in providing employment opportunities to family members or relatives of existing employees. We ensure that there are no direct/indirect reporting relationships/conflict of interest between the position held by the new incumbent and the family member.

II. Coverage:

Family members and relatives of existing employees.

III. Process:

- The process of application and selection remains the same as mentioned in clause 3C “External Recruitment”
- It is purely a merit-based appointment.

H) Campus Recruitment

I. Preamble:

The primary goal of hiring from campus is to bring in fresh talent and influx diversity.

II. Process:

The process shall be broadly divided into 3 categories:

- Pre-Hiring (Requirement Gathering)
- During Campus Hiring (Assessment & Selection)
- Post-Hiring (Analytics)

Pre-Hiring (Requirement Gathering)

Our strategy begins even before the students apply or we venture into the field to search for them. The backend work begins by listing the **staffing needs** by specifying the key positions/roles that the Organization is looking to fill.

Determine the number of hires - decide the number of people we need to need for each program/domain.

Shortlist Best Campuses - Our talent acquisition manager studies the market to shortlist institutes that provide relevant social sector education. One valuable exercise is reaching out to career center staff at the colleges or universities we want to target for campus recruitment. We also connect with the faculty, administrators and other vital contacts on campus. These individuals offer insight into the skills and attributes of their student body and also introduce us to career-minded students.

During Campus Hiring - (Assessment & Selection)

Pre-Placement Talk - This is where we officially introduce them to the organization, its environment and culture and growth prospects.

Assess to Identify - The highlighting feature of this process is its **standardization**. All the candidates are asked the same questions in the same order to ensure consistency and promote an unbiased way of evaluation. Structured interviews are **well planned in advance**, where the interviewer is clear about the competencies he/she wishes to measure and does so with the prepared questions. This may involve a written test for initial screening before the structured interview in order to filter the candidates and select only those who meet the minimum criteria for the role.

The offer process is the same as mentioned in the earlier section.

Post-Hiring (Analytics)

We maintain a campus scorecard that marks students as low, average and high based on their performance in assessments taken. Mapping the overall performance of the students, campuses are then aligned as per the performance hierarchy. The scores of various campuses is a benchmark used to rank them in order of preference.

III. Internship opportunities

SNEHA offers internship opportunities to students of institutes that are engaged with us. Not all internships result in a full-time position. By offering internships, we aim to form a professional relationship with college students who might become employees sometime in the future or at least would be likely to recommend SNEHA to peers in their network who are looking for employment**.**

IV. Tapping into the Alumni Network

Every institute has an alumni network. We collaborate with institutes that help us engage with their alumni groups. We post jobs on their alumni networks and invite applications for various roles. This helps us get relevant candidates and also references of candidates who would be interested in the roles we offer.

SECTION II - COMPENSATION

The following sections are covered in this section:

I. **Compensation Policy**
II. **Structure**
III. **Determinants of Compensation**
IV. **Compensation Revision**
V. **Gratuity**

A) Compensation Policy

I. Preamble:

The goals of our compensation policy are:

- To maintain pay competitiveness in relation to the external market
- To maintain internal equity and fairness based on an employee's performance and contribution

Compensation is structured such that all employees receive a Basic Salary. Expenses incurred towards housing & official conveyance and telephone are addressed through the provision of suitable House Rent Allowance & Travel and Telephone Allowance. These allowances are fixed for all the levels in the organization.

The organization also provides benefits in addition to the monthly salary. These benefits include Employers PF, Gratuity & Group Medical Insurance.

II. Compensation Structure:

The design of the compensation structure has been kept simple and easy to understand. In order to bring uniformity, internal equity & general parity within jobs of similar responsibility levels, indicative pay ranges & the concept of threshold salary has been introduced.

The current compensation structure for Level 1 staff is given below:

Level 1 Staff (CO/Assistants/Officers)

Following are the components of the current management compensation structure:

1. Basic Salary
2. House Rent Allowance
3. Telephone & Transport Allowance
4. Medical Allowance
5. Supplementary Allowance

In addition to the above, the following **BENEFITS** are provided:

1. Employer's PF.
2. Group Medical Insurance for Self.
3. Gratuity

Level 2 Staff (Coordinators and above)

The following are the components of the non-management compensation structure:

1. Basic Salary
2. House Rent Allowance
3. Transport Allowance
4. Medical Allowance
5. Supplementary Allowance

In addition to the above, the following **BENEFITS** are provided:

1. Employer's PF.
2. Group Medical Insurance for Self.
3. Gratuity

III. Determination of Compensation:

At the time of recruitment, the total compensation of a potential employee is fixed taking into account the employee's current salary (if applicable), qualifications & experience profile vis-a-vis current employees, budget & the criticality of the requirement.

IV. Compensation Revision:

Compensation reviews are undertaken to reward performance of employees as well as remunerate them for job enhancement.

Compensation is revised in either of the following modes:

IV.1. Annual Compensation Revision:

Usually takes place in the month of April and takes into account performance of last year & funding available. HR presents the proposed annual HR budget with staff increment (average) for the following financial year to the Trustee board for approval along with the organization budget. The budget is presented in the quarterly trustee board meeting before the financial year end. The Trustee board approves the overall organization budget which includes the HR budget.

In the month of April, post the performance appraisal exercise is completed, HR presents the principles of compensation revision to the HR Trustee board member. The principles include organization-wide rating distribution, proposed increment grid-based on ratings, the overall increment impact – budget v/s actuals, salary correction proposals if any.

Feedback is obtained from the HR Trustee Board member and based on the principles agreed, annual increments are released.

IV.2. Revision on Role Change/Promotion:

A change in role that requires different skills sets OR a promotion to the next level may lead to change in compensation. Once the internal applicant clears the selection process, HR decides on the revised salary band based on the criteria mentioned in the recruitment section.

V. Gratuity:

Gratuity is payable to the employee at the time of separation from the Organization, as per the Law. Gratuity is calculated as per the guidelines stipulated under the **Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972:**

Gratuity shall be payable to an employee on separation if he/she has rendered continuous service for not less than 5 years. The separation can be due to:

1. Retirement
2. Resignation.
3. On death or disability due to accident or disease.

As per **Provision 1 to Sec 4 (1)**, the completion of continuous service of 5 years is not required where termination of employment is due to death or disablement. In such cases, mandatory gratuity is payable.

Gratuity is paid at a rate of 15 days wages for every completed year of service or part thereof in excess of six months. The wages here mean wages last drawn by the employee. The "15 Days Wages" will be calculated by dividing the last drawn wages by 26 and multiplying the result with 15. The maximum gratuity that is payable is fixed at Rs 20,00,000/-, as per the **Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972.**

SECTION III - TERMS OF EMPLOYMENT

The following sections are covered in this chapter:

A. **Work Week & Work Hours**
B. **Leave Policy**
C. **Attendance and Leave Process**

A) Work Week & Work Hours

I. Preamble:

This section defines the work week & work hours for all employees of the Organization.

II. Coverage:

All on-roll employees.

III. Structure:

3A The **current work week** for all employees is Monday to Friday and one Saturday of the month totaling 48 hours a week.

3B Every employee works on either 1st Saturday OR 3rd Saturday of the month based on the program needs.

3C Offices and centers remain closed on 2nd, 4th and 5th Saturday of the month and on Public holidays based on the public holiday calendar circulated by HR.

3D Our office timings are 9:30 am to 5:30 pm.

B) Leave Policy

I. Preamble:

Leave is granted for reasons of health and general well-being of an employee. The Organization recognizes that all employees are eligible for paid time off that maintains their health, creativity and morale and subsequently has a positive impact on their performance & productivity in the Organization.

Annual leave also provides space to the employee to meet necessary family commitments.

II. Eligibility Criteria/Coverage:

All employees

III. LEAVE CYCLE:

Leave cycle will be April to March.

IV. TYPE OF LEAVES:

a) Privilege Leave
b) Maternity Leave
c) Paternity Leave
d) Adoption Leave
e) Compensatory Off

a) PRIVILEGE LEAVE (PL)

Entitlement

On Probation

- Employees on probation will get a credit of 1 PL a month for the first 3 months of probation. i.e., the probationer will get 3 PLs in a total of 3 months.
- Post confirmation, the employee gets a PL credit of 2.75 days a month
- PL will be credited on pro-rata basis at the beginning of the confirmation month
- In case of extension of probation, the employee will continue to get a credit of 1 PL a month till confirmation.
- In case the probationer does not avail PLs during probation period, this leave will not be carried forward on confirmation i.e., **unavailed PL during probation period will lapse on confirmation.**

First year leave cycle:

In the first year of joining, the total PLs credited to an employee will be up to a maximum of 27.75 days depending on the date of confirmation.

Leave cycle thereafter

- Employees are entitled to 33 days PL per financial year
- Employees will accrue 2.75 days a month to a maximum of 33 days PL in a financial year

Accumulation/Carry Forward

- We encourage employees to enjoy their PL on an annual basis. However, in case any employee is not in a position to consume PL in a particular financial year, PL not exceeding 15 days will be carried forward to the next financial year. Leaves above 15 days will lapse automatically at the end of the leave calendar year. PL to an employee's credit cannot exceed 48 days at any given point in time.

General Rules

- PL can be prefixed or suffixed with weekly offs/Organization declared holidays (Public Holiday)
- Intervening Organization declared holidays (Public Holiday) falling within the period of leave availed will be counted as part of PL.
- Weekends falling within the period of leave availed will be counted as PL. for e.g., if an employee applies for leave from 1st of the month to 15th of the month, Saturdays and Sundays that fall within that period of leave will be counted as PL
- Holidays preceding and/or succeeding PL shall not be counted as PL
- PLs need to be pre-approved by the Supervisor.
- On resignation and while serving Notice Period, the resignee cannot avail PL
- Maximum limit of PL to be availed is 21 days
- If an employee wants to take more than 15 days leave, he/she can avail post approval from their respective supervisor and APD/PD

b). MATERNITY LEAVE (ML)

Entitlement

- A female employee may be granted maternity leave on full pay for a period of 26 weeks for the first two children and 12 weeks for the third child.
- ML cannot be prefixed/suffixed with any other leave
- Maternity Leave may also be granted up to a maximum of 6 weeks, in case of miscarriage/medical termination of pregnancy twice in the tenure of service.

Availing Criteria

- ML can be availed 8 weeks prior to the birth of the child.
- In order to avail ML, the concerned female employee must submit medical certificate stating the probable date of delivery to HR and indicating desire to go on ML with specific dates for HR to do the needful.

c). PATERNITY LEAVE

Entitlement

A male employee may be granted paternity leave on full pay for a period of 15 days.

Availing Criteria

- Paternity leave can be availed within 6 months of the birth of the child.
- Can be availed for a maximum of 2 children

General Rules

- Leave has to be approved by the Supervisor a month in advance
- Paternity Leave cannot be prefixed/suffixed with any other leave
- Paternity leave cannot be carried forward
- Paternity leave cannot be claimed for any other reason or set off against leave of any other nature.

d). ADOPTION LEAVE

Entitlement

A woman who legally adopts a child below the age of three months or a commissioning mother shall be entitled to paid maternity benefit for a period of 12 weeks from the date the child is handed over to the adopting mother or commissioning mother as the case may be.

Availing Criteria

- Adoption Leave should be availed within 6 months of the adoption
- Can be availed for a maximum of 2 children

General Rules

- Leave has to be approved by the Supervisor at least a month in advance
- Adoption leave cannot be prefixed/suffixed with any other leave
- Adoption leave cannot be carried forward
- Adoption leave cannot be claimed for any other reason or set off against leave of any other nature

e). COMPENSATORY OFF

Entitlement

- Employees, due to exigency of work, have to attend duty/NGO-organized training programs on holidays as listed out in the public holiday list or on weekly off day, shall be entitled to avail compensatory off on any working day of their choice.
- If the employee attends training opted by the employee and not organized by the company, on a working day, public holiday or on weekly off day, the employee is not entitled for a compensatory off.
- Such compensatory off should be availed within 10 days.

General Rules

- Compensatory off may be either prefixed and/or suffixed by a holiday or weekly off
- Approval of the reporting supervisor is a must for grant of compensatory off specifying the day/date of the holiday/weekly off on which the employee has worked
- Compensatory off is not allowed to be carried forward beyond 10 days.

Unpaid Leave for Probationers

- Probationers are permitted to avail some advance leave at the sole discretion of the Reporting Supervisor, for reasons given below:

  - ✓ Personal illness
  - ✓ Serious illness/death of a family member
  - ✓ Marriage
  - ✓ Professional examinations and reasonable preparatory time

- Such leave requests should be made at least a month in advance in case of marriage/exams
- Such leave can be availed for a maximum period of seven days
- Such leave request shall be treated as leave without pay
- The reporting supervisor is the final authority to sanction such leave requests
- The reporting supervisor shall intimate sanction of such leave to HR immediately
- Upon confirmation by reporting supervisor/HR, the probationer is permitted to avail advance leave

General

If an employee is transferred from the one project/location to another, the leave entitlement shall remain intact and shall be credited to their account at the new project/location.

Full discretion shall rest with the management to grant leave, to refuse or revoke such leave at any time according to the exigencies of service of the organization. This shall not, however, be interpreted in such a way as to abridge the leave entitlements of the employees, and employees should, as far as possible, be encouraged to take leave at regular intervals.

Leave Summary

Leave Type	Leave Applicable to	Entitlement	Accumulation	Leave Lapse	Prefix/Suffix
Privilege Leave	First Year of Joining Post Confirmation	Maximum 27.75 days	48 days	Leave balance over 15 days at the end of March will lapse	Sandwich leave. Can be prefixed or suffixed with weekly offs/Public Holiday
	2nd year of joining and thereafter	33 days			
Probationers Leave	Probationers	1 PL a month till confirmation	Maximum upto 6 days in 6 months	Utilized leave will lapse on confirmation	Sandwich leave. Can be prefixed or suffixed with weekly offs/Public Holiday
Unpaid Leave for Probationers	Probationers	7 days unpaid leave	Not Applicable	NA	Cannot be prefixed/suffixed with any other leave
Maternity Leave	Women Employees	26 weeks	Not Applicable	NA	Cannot be prefixed/ suffixed with any other leave
Paternity Leave	Male Employees	15 days	Not Applicable	NA	Cannot be prefixed/ suffixed with any other leave
Adoption Leave	Women Employees	12 weeks	Not Applicable	NA	Cannot be prefixed/ suffixed with any other leave

C) Attendance & Leave Process

Guidelines for Attendance

1. For the purpose of payroll, attendance record from 21st of the last month till 20th of the current month is considered. Any adjustment from the previous month payroll cycle affecting pay will be considered in the current month's payroll.

2. SNEHA uses PEOPLEWORKS (PW) as its HR information system that records attendance and leaves of employees and consultants.

3. **SNEHA"s office timings are 9.30 am to 5.30 pm.** Monday to Friday and 1st and 3rd Saturday a month. SNEHA offers flexibility of 1.5 hours morning and evening to employees. The following 4 scenarios are acceptable for attendance registration

    a. An employee can login at 9 am and logout at 5 pm.
    b. An employee can login at 9.30 am and logout at 5.30 pm.
    c. An employee can login at 10 am and logout at 6 pm
    d. An employee can login at 10.30 am and logout at 6.30 pm

    It is mandatory to complete 8 hours of working every day for payment of salary. The system (PW) gives a levy of 15 mins i.e., even if an employee completes 7 hours 45 mins, employee is marked "Present" in PW. If on any day, an employee does not complete minimum 7 hours 45 mins, system will mark "Loss of Pay" for half day as the employee has not completed the required number of hours either in the first half of the day or second half of the day. This is irrespective of whether the employee logs in on time i.e. 10:30 am or before. This is the concept of "Loss of Pay"

4. **Our CORE working hours are 10.30 am to 5 pm.** i.e., every employee is expected to be present ON DUTY at this time.

5. An employee who logs in after 10.30 am on any day will be penalized for half day of PL from the 3rd occurrence of such instance. Half day PL will be automatically deducted from PL balance. Employee cannot apply for regularization in such cases and PL deducted against this will not be reversed.

6. Similarly, an employee who logs out before 5 pm on any day will be penalized for half day of PL from the 3rd occurrence of such instance. Half day PL will be automatically deducted from PL balance. Employee cannot apply for regularization in such cases and PL deducted against this will not be reversed.

7. All on-roll employees and consultants are required to register login time and logout time every day to register their presence in office.

8. On-roll employees are expected to regularize their attendance before the 20th of every month.

9. If an employee fails to regularize their attendance by 20th of the month, gap in attendance is considered as Leave without Pay (LWP).

Guidelines for Leave Application

1. For the purpose of payroll, leave record from 21st of the last month till 20th of the current month is considered. Any adjustment from the previous month payroll cycle affecting pay will be considered in the current month's payroll.

1. Leaves have to be approved by the Supervisor for HR to be considered as paid leaves.

2. In case HR finds discrepancy in the attendance and leave records of an employee, the gap is considered Leave Without Pay (LWP) and salary for those many days is deducted from the month's payroll.

Please refer to FAQs and Training Module on PEOPLEWORKS for attendance and leave application process.

SECTION IV - PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT

The following Sections are covered in this Chapter:

A. **Performance Reviews**

B. **Promotions**

C. **Management of Poor Performance**

A) Performance Reviews (Appraisal)

I. Preamble:

The contribution of individual staff to the achievement of program/domain objectives is ultimately what is measured in Performance Management. The Performance Management process helps every employee align his/her performance with the organization's objectives.

This is achieved through programs and domain plan cascaded down until they are reflected in some way in individual performance plans and through individual and group achievements which build upwards towards the accomplishment of organization goals.

The quality and skill of people is central to the continued success of SNEHA. It is therefore important that our employees are continuously improving their skills, gaining knowledge and expertise in their field of operations.

To this end, the Performance Management process is a key vehicle to define how each employee is to grow and develop from year to year, to reach their full potential and make maximum contribution to the organization performance.

II. Coverage:

- All employees

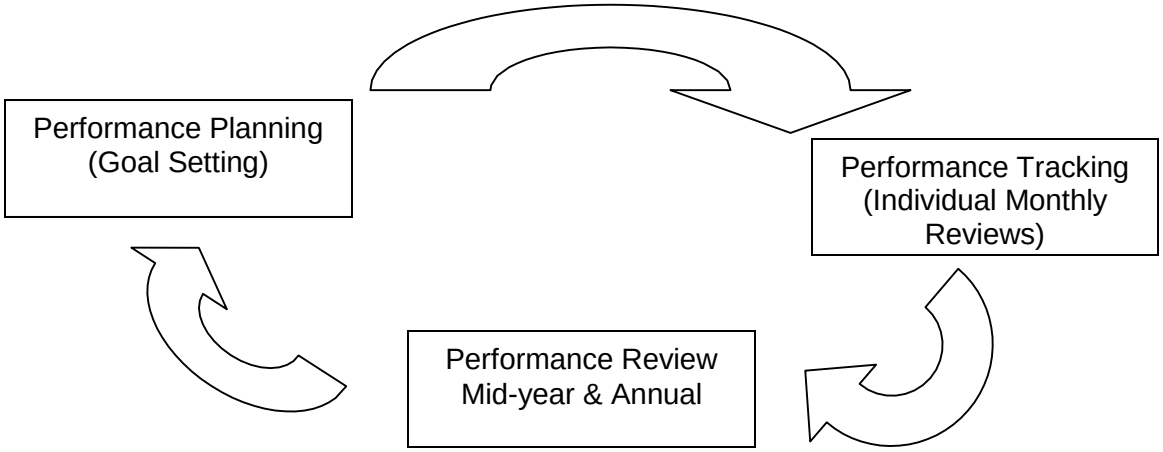
The **Performance Appraisal Year** runs from **April to March**. To be eligible for appraisal, an employee must have completed at least 6 months in the current appraisal year.

- Those Employees joining/promoted between 1st April 2020 & 1st October 2020 will be eligible for an annual appraisal increment.
- Those Employees joining/promoted between 2nd October 2020 & 31st March 2021 will not be eligible for an annual appraisal increment.

III. Process:

Performance Management Process

-



The Performance Management Process begins with Performance Planning. This exercise takes place along with an employee's appraisal.

Appraisals are usually conducted in the month of March.

IIIA Performance Planning (Goal Setting):

This begins with a review of the organization's plan. Further program/domain's plans are developed. Every employee has a goal sheet in a specific format which has SMART goals stated. The goals are discussed and agreed with the employee by the Supervisor at the beginning of the financial year. The goals are then sent to HR for records.

IIIB Performance Tracking:

B1 Performance tracking aims at providing employees with ongoing feedback and guidance on their work performance. Such feedback is based on actual performance in the current performance period.

B2 Goals set in the beginning of the year are reviewed half yearly (**Mid-Year Review)** in order to realign them (if required), based on changes in the program strategy and goals and also to provide feedback to employees to help them achieve their goals. The same is appropriately recorded in the **Mid-Year Review Form**.

B3 Mid-Year Review takes place in the month of October.

B4 Programs conduct weekly/monthly meetings to provide guidance in day-to-day activities, form weekly plans, and discuss support required from the Supervisor/team etc.

IIIC Annual Performance Review:

Performance Review is the process of coming to a conclusion on the employee's overall performance rating for the foregoing performance period.

Performance Review has 2 parts:

Self-Appraisal:

Self-appraisal is an important aspect of the Performance Review Process. All on-roll employees must fill in the self-appraisal form before meeting their appraiser for the Performance Review Meeting.

Performance Review Meeting:

The purpose of the performance review meeting is to get clarity and agreement on what eventually becomes the final performance review document.

It is also the forum to reach agreement on any difference in points of view about actual performance descriptions and ratings before a final version of the performance document is written up.

The Performance Review Process begins with gathering of performance inputs and ends when the employee, the appraiser & the appraiser's appraiser (reviewer) have all signed the documented Appraisal Form.

Role of Reviewer (Supervisor of the Appraiser):

The reviewer's role is to ensure overall quality of the performance management process for his/her program/domain and to see that there is comparative equity among supervisor's reviews of their team members.

This cannot be achieved effectively if the reviewer only gets involved in reviewing the finalized documentation. Ideally, his/her involvement begins at performance planning time to ensure that expectations set are equitable.

When presented with the completed Performance Management form, the reviewer also takes note of employee comments, if any. The comments may indicate how the employee felt about his/her supervisor. Any dissenting views are discussed upon.

IIID Moderation

To ensure uniformity in rating patterns is maintained across the organization, HR meets the Program Director/Domain Heads and discusses with a detailed analysis, the rating distribution, significant patterns and extreme ratings in their program/domains. Extreme ratings may be moderated at this stage, should a need for the same arise.

The overall organization Performance Ratings Analysis is then presented to the CEO who validates the ratings and moderates the same further, if required, in order to conform to the standards, set and the norms established.

The organization-wide analysis is also presented to the HR Trustee board member and feedback is obtained based on which the principles of increment are finalized and executed.

IIIE Appraisal Process General Guidelines:

- In case an employee is transferred from one program/domain to another, both supervisors will appraise the employee for the duration spent in their respective program/domains. The performance will be reviewed by the program/domain where majority of the time has been spent during the appraisal year

- In case a supervisor is transferred from one program/domain to another, he/she will complete appraisals for employees working under him/her for the duration worked together

- In case an employee and appraiser are not convinced with the rating marked, as an exception HR will intervene as a moderator and will ensure both have received a healthy and justified outcome

3F Indicative Timelines:

An indicative time schedule is given below for the **appraisal process:**

Activity	**Approximate Timeframe**
Appraisal Workshop	February
Self-Appraisal	March
Performance Review Meeting	March
Validation and Moderation	April
Submission of Final Rating	April
Compensation Review Proposal Finalization	April
Release of Individual Compensation Review Letters	End April
Objective Setting for Next Year	March - April
Mid-Year Review	October

B) Promotions

I. Preamble:

The policy on promotions provides a framework for assessment of employees who have been recommended for promotions/who have been selected for next level positions.

II. Coverage:

All employees

IIA Promotions:

The following vertical movements are considered as promotions:

PROGRAMS		DOMAINS	
From	**To**	**From**	**To**
Community Organizer	Program Officer	Assistant	Officer
Program Officer	Program Coordinator	Officer	Coordinator
Program Coordinator	Associate Program Director	Coordinator	Supervisor
Associate Program Director	Program Director	Supervisor	Associate Domain Director
		Associate Domain Director	Domain Director
Cross functional movements and promotions are also encouraged to provide development opportunities to Employees			

The primary **requirements for recommending** employees for a promotion are:

- Consistent above average performance
- Tenure in the current role
- Significant enhancement in role & responsibility
- Potential to take on higher responsibilities

IIB Assessment Criteria:

The following factors and conditions will be considered while assessing employees for promotions:

B1 Qualifications

B1.1 For promotions to Coordinator/PC level and above, the minimum qualification required is post-graduation.

B1.2 For promotions from Community Organizer to PO/Officer level, the minimum qualification is graduation.

B2 Tenure within the organization & in the Current Position

A minimum of 1 year of service in the organization and in the current role is required.

B3 Overall Years of Experience

To be eligible for a promotion to a new level, the employee must have the following minimum years of experience:

Roles	Minimum Years" Experience
Program/Domain Director	15+ years
Associate Program/Domain Director	10+ years
Coordinator/Program Coordinator	6+ years
Officer/Program Officer	3+ years

NOTE: *Exceptions or Deviations in the assessment criteria* can be made only with the joint approval of the CEO & HR.

B4 Enhancement in Job Profile & Responsibility

B4.1 There may be occasions when job roles are enlarged or valued higher on account of their criticality to the programs/domains in so far as the impact the job exerts. Such an evaluation will need to be suitably explained by the recommending supervisor & approved by the Program Director/Domain Head and HR.

B4.2 The employees past performance, additional responsibilities undertaken and conduct at work will also be taken into account here.

B5 Criticality of Skills & Impact on Organization

B5.1 The importance of an individual's skills & the consequent impact they have on the success of organizational objectives at a point of time are examined here. In recommending promotions, the criticality of the competence/skill and its increased influence/importance should be clearly established.

B5.2 The individual's critical skills may in most cases require only salary corrections & need not call for promotion to a higher level.

B6 Competencies or Skills Acquired

The degree to which the employee has obtained new skills, updated current skills or pursued professional development (e.g. professional association) valuable to the organization

B7 Vacancy in new/proposed role as per the organization chart for the program/domain

A vacancy should normally exist for the role to which the employee is being recommended. In case such a vacancy does not exist, the onus for justifying the creation of a new role rests with the recommending supervisor. The Program Director/Domain Head must first obtain approval from the CEO clearly specifying the requirement and the need for the role. The Finance Director needs to approve the budget.

B8 Potential Appraisal

B8.1 The recommending supervisor should be able to estimate what would be the effectiveness of the individual (who is being recommended for promotion) in the enhanced role & responsibility that he/she will be taking up.

B8.2 An assessment of this can be made from the type of assignments that the individual has handled & his/her performance & achievement level therein. Also, the leadership & interpersonal skills that the individual has demonstrated in the current role will set a benchmark on his/her potential.

III. Process:

3A As a policy, all vacancies are open to internal employees through IJP. HR advertises the position and invites internal applicants and follows the process of internal hiring as mentioned in Section I.

3B Promotion may lead to a revision in salary basis the principles mentioned in Section II.

3G Any exception to the above principles and process of promotion requires CEO approval.

C) Management of Poor Performance

BACKGROUND

With the introduction of the formal Performance Management System for all the employees, concept of relative performance evaluation through normal curve has also been introduced. This is in line with the SNEHA PMS philosophy of promoting a culture of meritocracy and drive a culture of performance excellence in the organization.

Performance Management will not only help us to identify the high performers but will also enable the identification of employees who need to improve their performance levels. In order to help the employees who are rated 1 & 2 during the Performance Management process, in improving their performance level we are introducing Performance Improvement Plan (PIP).

Duration:

- PIP will be for a period of 3 months.

Eligibility:

- All the rating "1 & 2" cases shall be accessed by the superior to ascertain whether with proper guidance and support there is a scope of improvement in performance level or not.
- If the superior feels that the employee has potential to improve his/her performance then such identified employees will be put under PIP.
- If the superior, in consultation with the respective HEAD OF PROGRAM/DOMAIN, feel that there is no scope of improvement, then the employee will be asked to look at alternate options beyond SNEHA.

Process:

- Goal setting for PIP

  - The employee along with supervisor will prepare a PIP and set the goals to be achieved.
  - The goals set should have clear cut deliverables with measurable targets spanning over 3 months. The deliverables identified should be specific to the employee's work area.
  - The supervisor and employee should sign and date the plan.
  - This plan should be completed within the set time frame from start of the PIP.
  - Both the employee and the supervisor should work together to ensure achievement of the PIP goals.

- Feedback

  - The employee and the respective reporting supervisor need to have a formal dialogue 30 days after the PIP goals are decided and signed off.
  - The respective Business HR shall also be a part of the dialogue and ensure quality of PIP and its implementation both in letter and in spirit.
  - Although a formal feedback and performance review has been set for every 45 days, the reporting supervisor is advised to hold weekly/fortnightly discussions with the

employee on the deliverables identified with the aim at guiding the employee to take corrective action(s).

- Evaluation
  - The supervisor should closely review the performance of the employee on PIP so that by the end of the 3 month period he/she is certain whether the employee on PIP has shown improvement or whether he/she is a case for exit.

PROCESS FOR HANDLING PIP (Performance Improvement Plan) OUTCOME

The duration of PIP (Performance Improvement Plan) is 3 months or more as appropriate. At the end of 3 months or the duration of PIP, there can be two scenarios

Scenario A – Supervisor recommends that employee who has undergone PIP shows substantial progress in the areas of improvement identified vis-a-vis the Plan and is fit to be put in normal course of work.

Scenario B - Supervisor recommends that employee who was put on PIP has shown little or no progress on the areas of improvement identified vis-a-vis Plan.

Scenario A

Employees who have successfully completed PIP

- ✓ Step 1- Post you get confirmation from the concerned Department Head on successful completion of PIP, as a next step, the concerned department head conducts a formal meeting with the employee and communicates to the employee about completion of PIP & documents his/her performance records as well as share with employee where he is doing well and his/her improvement areas.

- ✓ Step 3 - Immediate Supervisor must advice the employee that he needs to maintain the expected level of performance & conduct periodic reviews with him/her and show his willingness to help the employee whenever required. Also, HR must be present during such meeting with employee along with supervisor.

Scenario B

Employee who has shown little/no improvement in PIP term.

- ✓ Step 1 - The immediate supervisor will complete a PIP documenting the specific performance/behavior issue, which leads to the conclusion that the PIP has not been successful, and get an agreement of the concerned head of program/domain on the next steps.

- ✓ Step 2 - Post receiving approval of the concerned business leader, HR must ensure that immediate supervisor schedules a meeting with the employee for the discussion along with concerned head of program/domain and HR.

- ✓ Step 3 - In the meeting, the HEAD OF PROGRAM/DOMAIN should brief that based on outcome of PMS, the employee was rated 1/2 and hence was put on PIP. As an outcome of PIP, it has been decided that the employee's performance has not been up to desired level and hence the employee is encouraged to explore for opportunities beyond SNEHA. The employee should be asked to write a letter in their own handwriting addressed to his HEAD OF PROGRAM/DOMAIN requesting for separation. Post getting the letter HR will then have the application given by the employee signed by the HEAD OF PROGRAM/DOMAIN & immediate supervisor mentioning a date of reliving which should the same day as date of resignation and send it to settlement team for processing the settlement.

- ✓ Step 4 – In case an employee refuses to resign and engages in a conversation on reason for the outcome, we issue a letter of termination on the basis of poor performance. In case an employee refuses to accept the letter then we will send the letter via courier or registered AD to communication address as per our records.

Important Pointers

- ✓ Meeting with the employee in both the scenarios (Scenario A & B) will be conducted in office hours & in office only.
- ✓ In Scenario B, the entire process will be completed within 7 working days of personal interaction with the employee
- ✓ The employee (In scenario B) would be paid salary as per rules in settlement.

SECTION V – TRAINING & DEVELOPMENT

The following sections are covered in this chapter:

A) Training & Development Philosophy

I. Preamble:

SNEHA recognizes the importance of having skilled employees in order to achieve strategic and operational plans and is committed to providing an environment that is conducive to effective performance and promotes training and development opportunities for all employees.

To provide a framework for training and development that ensures employees have necessary skills to deliver on SNEHA"s strategic and operational plans.

II. Coverage:

All employees who join SNEHA are covered under this policy.

III. POLICY:

There is equality of opportunity for all SNEHA employees to develop their knowledge, skills and abilities through a blend of learning methods including training, coaching, on the job learning, courses (including online), conferences and seminars as applicable to the role.

a. Training Needs Assessment

- The training needs are collated from the employee appraisal forms every year by the Training Officers (TOs) in the programs or by those designated by the Directors in case the program does not have a designated Training Officer

- The Capacity Building Learning Development (CBLD) Head meets the Program Director and groups of employees to finalise the needs along with the TO.

- Once the development needs are collated, an annual training calendar is prepared by the TOs with a sign off by the concerned APD/Director.

- Learning needs are also identified at other times based on the needs of the program, organisation and the environment.

- SNEHA cares for employee well-being. Need-based training on mental health issues and identification of symptoms, mindfulness and mind management training are also part of the training repertoire.

b. Staff Counselling services

A staff counsellor has been appointed for one on one counselling session with employees and visits SNEHA offices four times a month, as per a pre-decided schedule. A quarterly report is provided to CEO, Program Director (PVWC) and CBLD head stating the utilization of the services and any emerging themes that may need to be addressed, challenges faced by the counsellor etc keeping full confidentiality of the individual employees.

c. External Training

- Information about external training is provided by the CBLD Head through an active process of identifying high-quality resources subject to availability of budget.

- The Heads/Associate Program Directors nominate members based on needs assessed.

- Employees need to fill in an application form with details of the program, duration of course, fees, justification for attending the program, state how they will apply their newly gained knowledge in their current role or help in achieving organisational goals.

- A copy of the material received during an external training is given to the respective program and the organisation for future reference.

- The CBLD Head as well as the Training Officers in program teams maintain a database of external trainers which includes justification for using their services, approximate costing, past experience with the trainer and any other information that is relevant for ready reference by the organisation.

d. Short-term external training programs and certifications

- SNEHA sometimes requires employees to attend specialised training programs and certifications either to comply with certain governance requirements or to improve quality of work outcomes. In such cases, SNEHA may partially/fully fund the cost of such programs, subject to availability of Budgets/funding.

- The application process for this is the same as for the other training.

- For courses/certifications that have been planned and budgeted for with approved donor grants at the beginning of a financial year, the Program/Domain Heads/APDs can approve attendance to such programs.

- Courses/certifications that have not been planned/budgeted: Employees need to complete the application form, take approval from the Program Director, CBLD Head for justification of the program and take approval from CEO/Finance Director for Budget allocation. Such courses/certifications will be granted one time over a period of 2 years.

- In case, the employee resigns from SNEHA within one year of completing a program/conference, partially or fully funded by SNEHA, the entire amount paid by SNEHA will be deducted from the employee's settlement dues. The Program Director to inform the CBLD Head who informs the HR & FIN Heads about the program/conference the employee attended, the amount paid by SNEHA for the deductions to be made.

- Exceptions to the above have to be approved by the Program Director, the CEO or the Finance Head.

e. Training Evaluation

- All training is evaluated to identify changes and improvements in training provision. Evaluation is retained by the CBLD Head and shared with respective program/domain team heads.

- Post the trainee attends a training program, the supervisor takes feedback on the training attended, checks on learning and makes a plan of how the learning can be utilised at the workplace. This is also recorded in the performance appraisal process twice a year.

f. Training Budget

A training Budget is prepared by the CBLD Head at the start of the financial year which is reviewed at the end of the year.

g. Coaching

The coaching intervention is offered to Program Coordinators and above at SNEHA, and the process is voluntary. The intervention is dependent on the availability of pro bono coaches.

h. Evaluation of coaching

- Learning through coaching is evaluated mid-way and at the end of the process by the coach, coachee and the supervisor.

i. National and International Conferences

- Program Directors, Associate Program Directors, Domain Managers, and Consultants attend national and international conferences to present research papers and posters. They are encouraged to apply for partial or full scholarships to the organisers. If partially funded, the final approval for payment is taken by the CEO subject to the availability of funding.

- Travel for all SNEHA sponsored external training/courses/conferences is borne by the organisation.

SECTION VI – STAFF WELFARE

The following sections are covered in this chapter:

A) Group Health Insurance Policy

B) Medical Assistance Policy

C) Education Assistance Policy

D) Public Holiday

E) Grievance Redressal Policy

A) Group Health Insurance Policy

I. Preamble:

As part of SNEHA"s commitment to employee well-being and to provide a safety net to employees for obtaining quality medical treatment, the organization provides Group Health Insurance for all employees.

II. SNEHA Coverage:

All employees.

III. Entitlement:

Employees are entitled for medical treatment in a network of clinics and hospitals up to a limit of Rs. 1,00,000/-

V. Policy Coverage:

- Minimum of 24 hrs hospitalization is mandatory
- 24 hrs stay is not mandatory for DAY CARE PROCEDURE. (Covers 144 treatments)
- Treatment to be taken at registered hospitals only.
- Admission/Hospitalization should be for active medical treatment and should not be for only investigations, evaluation and observation

III. Process:

3.1 HR informs the medical insurance agency about the new employees joining the organization and their individual medical insurance cards are issued within one week of joining.

3.2 To avail treatment, the employee has to present the insurance card at the clinic/hospital concerned.

3.3 On leaving the organization, employee returns the insurance card to HR Department; the same is communicated to the agency and the card surrendered to them.

3.4 Organization pays an annual premium to the insurance agency based on the number of employees, their age and the time spent in the organization in that year.

Cashless Claim Procedure at Network Hospitals:

- Fill in the pre – authorization form – available at TPA desk of network hospitals
- Fax the form to: 022 – 66314781
- Authorization for cashless facility will be issued at Network Hospitals only, subject to the policy conditions
- Contact points from FHPL - Ms. Rakhi Bait
- TAT for Pre-authorization: 3 hours from receipt of pre-authorization request from hospital, subject to complete information.
- Authorization letter will be approved for a particular amount, as per policy terms & conditions, and faxed back to the hospital.

Reimbursement Claim Procedure at Non-network Hospitals

- Claim documents will be sent to the TPA – **Family Health Plan Ltd**.
- A copy of all original documents sent should be maintained with the dealers to enable tracking of documents if required.
- TAT for processing 10 days
- TAT for releasing claim payment 15 days from submission of all the documents,
- Documents mentioned in check list to be submitted *in originals*
- Claims will not be processed with deficiency of documents
- Checklist of Enclosures for Submission of Claim (MRC)
  - Duly filled claim form
  - Discharge summary
  - Final bill and complete bill break up

- Payment receipt
- First consultation letter and subsequent prescriptions
- Original Bills, original payment receipts and reports for Investigations
- Original medicine bills and receipts with corresponding prescriptions
- Original invoice/bills for implants with original payment receipts
- Cancelled cheque with name printed on the same.

- **In the Case of Road Traffic Accident (in addition to above documents)**
  - Copy of the First Information Report from police department/ Copy of Medico legal certificate.
  - Treating doctors certificate giving details of injuries (How, when and where injury sustained)

- **In Accidental Death cases (in addition to above documents)**
  - Copy of Post Mortem Report and Death Certificate.

Documents should be submitted *in original* at the following address ***within 20 days*** *from the date of discharge.*

Ms. Rakhi Bait

Family Health Plan Ltd, Neelkanth Corporate Park, *Office No. 710 & 711, 7th Floor, Kirol Road, Opp. Vidyavihar Railway Station (west)*, *Mumbai - 400 086*

IV. Expenses Payable:

- Room charges
- Doctor"s fees
- Intensive Care Unit
- Nursing expenses
- Surgical fees, operating theatre, anesthesia and oxygen and their administration
- Drugs and medicines consumed on the premises
- Hospital miscellaneous services (such as laboratory, x-ray, diagnostic tests)
- Dressing and plaster casts
- Radiotherapy and chemotherapy

VI. Expenses Non-Payable:

- Admission/Registration
- Telephone charges
- Attendant's charges
- Home Visit/Nursing charges - at residence after discharge
- Assistant fee/Follow up charges in advance
- Sundry/Medico Legal Charges/Diabetic chart charges
- Thermometer Charges
- Container for Specimen/Disposable Bag charges
- Admission Kit
- External Surgical Aids: Lumbo-sacral/Collar belt /Knee cap/Knee brace/ walker/hot water bag/baby kit/urine pot / traction kit/ folding commode etc.
- Inhaler/ Nebulizer, Diet charges
- Special/protein diet/health drinks unless prescribed by the doctor
- Documentation/Folder/Stationery/In Patient chart charges

Exclusions

No Claims shall be payable in respect of any Insured Person directly or indirectly for, caused by, arising, from or in any way attributable to any of the following:

- Caused by or attributable to War
- Any insured person committing or attempting to commit a criminal or illegal act, or intentional self-injury or attempted suicide while sane or insane.
- Any insured person's participation or involvement in naval, military or air force operation, racing, diving, aviation, scuba diving, parachuting, hang-gliding, rock or mountain climbing.
- Drugs consumption.
- Psychiatric or mental disorders.
- AIDS/HIV.
- Dental Treatment.
- Plastic/Cosmetic surgery.
- Abuse of intoxicants substances such as drugs, alcohol, and smoking.
- Obesity related treatment.
- Congenital internal and external diseases.

- Genetic disorders.
- Any non-allopathic treatment.
- Note = For more details refer to policy wordings

Escalation matrix

	Level -1	Level – 2
FHPL	Ms.Rakhi Bait Rakhi.bait@in.fhpl.net 9004062994	Mr. Manoj Rewale manojrewale@fhpl.net 9223719195
Apollo Munich	Mr. Hanumanthayya Lakkam Praveen.vijayan@apollomunichinsurance.com 9987686899	Ms.Mangeshwari Reddy Mangeshwari.reddy@apollomunichinsurance.com 7738008635

List of network hospitals is available with the HR team. For more details on the policy, employee can reach out to the HR team.

B) Medical Assistance Policy

I. Objective

To provide medical assistance to our staff who have been injured while on duty and need medical treatment and *under the present situation of a global pandemic to cover adverse effects post Covid 19 vaccination or of any such preventive steps taken by the organisation, in the larger interest of the individual and/ Organisation and/ Community that require medical treatment without hospitalisation, by way of reimbursement of medical expenses which are not covered under Group Medical Insurance offered by SNEHA.

*After the pandemic is declared “over”, we may review the policy.

II. Eligibility

All full-time Community Organizers, Program Officers and equivalent, who have been injured while on duty and need medical treatment.

III. Policy

An employee while at work, during working hours of SNEHA, meets with an injury/ accident or has any adverse effects of post Covid 19 vaccination or of any such preventive steps taken by the organisation in the larger interest, that does not require hospitalisation and treatment of which is not covered under group medical insurance can claim reimbursement of medical expenses upto a limit of Rs. 5000 (Rupees Five thousand)

a. An employee is eligible to claim medical assistance in the form of reimbursement from the first day of joining SNEHA.

IV. Claim Process

a. Employees shall inform their Supervisor/APD in case of any such incident within 48 hours of the incident.
b. Employee shall submit original medical/doctor consultation bills and Medical Reports (if any) to their Supervisor/APD along with the Medical Reimbursement Form (Annexure I) and Incident Report (Annexure II) for approval.
c. Supervisor/APD shall verify the bills and submit the original medical/doctor consultation bills and Medical Reports (if any), Medical Reimbursement Form and Incident report to PD/Domain Head for approval.
d. PD/Domain Head verifies the documents and forwards the original medical/doctor consultation bills along with approved Cheque Payment Voucher and Medical Reimbursement Form to HR.
e. HR will verify the approvals, maintain employee records against this policy and forward it to Finance for reimbursement.
f. Medical reports (if any) shall be returned to the employee incase needed for future treatment.

V. Reimbursement Process

a. On receiving the original medical/doctor consultation bills along with Medical Reimbursement Form and Incident report and approved Cheque Payment Voucher, Finance shall reimburse the amount to the employee.

b. Reimbursement will be credited to the employee's salary account within 30 days of submission of relevant documents.

Any deviation or special consideration would require recommendation from the Program Director/Domain Head and approval from the CEO

Reimbursements under this policy are solely at the discretion of the management.

C) Education Assistance Policy

I. Objective

To provide assistance to our Community Organisers and equivalent, by way of reimbursing the tuition fees for higher studies. This could be high school certifications, graduate/post graduate programs that are job relevant.

II. Eligibility

All full-time Community Organisers and equivalent, who have completed at least one year of service with SNEHA and received a performance rating of “3” or higher in their last performance review.

Employee should have cleared the last examination taken (Secondary School/Higher Secondary School /Degree/Diploma or equivalent) before applying for the assistance.

III. Application Approving Authority

Applications that fall within the framework of this policy and follow the below mentioned procedure can be approved by the below mentioned approving authorities in consultation with HR and Finance.

Area	**Approving Authority**
All Programs	Respective Program Directors
Domains	Respective Domain Heads
Domains reporting directly to CEO	CEO

IV. Policy

1) Employee can enroll in high school/ graduate/post graduate degree program or take courses only at a fully accredited school, college or university.

2) The course/program should be a part time (class attendance during non-working hours of SNEHA/non-working Saturday and Sunday) OR distance learning program.

3) The funds provided to eligible employee under this benefit are available only for the reimbursement of tuition costs. Institutional fees, textbooks, supplies and other costs cannot be clubbed under this benefit.

4) An eligible employee would be reimbursed 50% of the entire course/program fee payable by them for acquiring a high school/graduate/post graduate degree OR Rs. 10,000/-, whichever is lower as Education Assistance.

5) The amount will be paid in tranches. The first installment of the education assistance would be paid to the eligible employee when he/she joins a particular course/program as admission fee.

6) The 2nd installment would be paid to the eligible employee upon successful completion of the first semester or course/program completion, whichever is applicable. The 3rd installment will be paid accordingly, if applicable. Therefore, the fee will be paid only after clearing the previous semester exams.

7) It is mandatory to produce documents indicating that employee has successfully passed the previous semester to avail benefit for the next semester under this policy.

8) Employee cannot claim the complete eligibility amount for any one semester only. The amount of reimbursement will be equally divided semester wise in cases where the course/program is semester based.

V. Employee who has already enrolled for a course/program prior to this policy coming into effect can claim reimbursement only for future semesters for that particular course/program.

VI. An employee can avail this benefit only twice in their career with SNEHA

VII. A minimum gap of 3 years from receiving the last reimbursement (for one complete course/program) is required between availing this benefit a second time.

VIII. The payment/reimbursement will be made to the employee and not to the Institution.

IX. Benefit of this policy can be claimed in **3 scenarios**:

A. **Prior to enrolling for the course/program** - Employee can approach the approving authority before an employee enrolls for the course/program.

B. **Immediately after enrolling for the course/program** - Employee can approach the approving authority after the employee has enrolled in a course/program and made the first payment to the institute.

C. **For an ongoing course/program** - Employee can approach the approving authority to claim benefit for an ongoing course/program they are pursuing for which benefit has not been claimed under this policy.

X. If the performance of an employee at work falls below acceptable levels, the approving authority may recommend HR to discontinue payment of further fees.

XI. HR will keep a record of all claims, payments and reimbursements being made under this policy.

XII. The employee has to submit final results once course/program is completed.

XIII. Approval Process

a. The employee submits the following documents to the approving authority:

- Institute Application Form (filled at the time of applying for the course/program)
- Prospectus and Fee structure
- Course/program Start and End Date details
- How the applicant expects to use the degree/certification to further his/her work at SNEHA.
- Passing certificate/results of (Secondary School/ Higher Secondary/Degree/Diploma or equivalent)
- Results of previous semester/s (applicable only if benefit is being availed under Scenarios B & C as given above)
- First Payment Receipt made to the Institute (applicable only if benefit is being availed under Scenario B)
- Notice of payment of fee issued by the Institution (applicable only if benefit is being availed under Scenarios B & C)
- Education Assistance Form (applicable only if benefit is being availed under Scenario A)
- Education Reimbursement Form (applicable only if benefit is being availed under Scenarios B & C)

b. The Request for education assistance must be submitted 30 days prior to enrolling for the course/program in case the employee wants the education assistance at the time of enrollment in the course/program.

c. The course/degree/certification being sought (including the institution) must be approved by the respective approving authority.

d. Whether or not a particular course/degree/certification is professional or directly related to the job or will be helpful to the employee concerned in performance of his work, will be decided by the organization at its sole discretion and the same shall be final. The

approving authority has to ensure that pursuance of any course/degree/certification by an employee should not in any way hamper the smooth flow of work in the department.

e. The approving authority sends a recommendation to HR for payment/reimbursement of course/program fee as applicable.

f. HR checks the eligibility of the employee as per guidelines of the policy, verifies the documents and checks the eligibility amount payable under the policy.

g. On verification, HR forwards the application to Finance with recommendation for overall limit sanction check along with all the original payment receipts (wherever applicable).

h. Finance does its due diligence and makes the payment to the Employee. Finance informs HR about the payment.

i. HR sends an email to Employee confirming payment.

j. Any deviation or special consideration will require recommendation from the Program Director/Domain Head and approval from the CEO.

D) Public Holidays

I. Preamble:

A list of Public Holidays & the allocated number of holidays for the year are circulated every year in December for the next calendar year.

II. Coverage:

All employees

III. Process:

3a HR issues a circular addressed to all Offices in December every year. 3b SNEHA gives 15 public holidays in a calendar year.

3c. Public holidays falling on 2nd/4th and 5th Saturday of the month are considered as holiday for all employees.

3c. Public holidays falling on 1st/3rd Saturday of the month are considered as holiday for employees working on that particular day. Employees are not required to work on the next working Saturday in lieu of public holiday falling on 1st/3rd Saturday of the month.

E) Grievance Redressal Policy

I. Preamble:

SNEHA believes in a flexible and open work culture which allows people the freedom to grow and perform at their optimum levels while being accountable to the goals of the organization.

However, in some situations, SNEHA personnel may have concerns or complaints regarding their work, working relationships or the working environment. Most of these concerns should be resolved informally through discussions within the program. In the event that personnel consider that their concerns have not been addressed adequately, they may raise a formal grievance under the procedures outlined in this policy.

The policy aims to ensure that where problems are identified, they are dealt with promptly, fairly and consistently.

II. Coverage:

All employees and consultants

III. Definitions

A “Grievance” is defined as „an official statement of a complaint over something believed to be wrong or unfair‟. A grievance is personal and may be about the personnel’s own employment position, treatment, work relationships, work environment, organization policies etc., where the complainant has a vested interest in its resolution

In this policy, "Complainant" refers to the personnel with a grievance and "Respondent" refers to the personnel against whom the grievance has been raised. The term "Parties" refers to the complainant and the respondent.

In this policy, "Personnel" are people who work for SNEHA under a contract of employment.

IV. Principles

All procedures and documents relating to a grievance should be treated confidentially and information will only be shared with the members of the Grievance Redressal Committee

Personnel should, wherever possible, try and resolve complaints and concerns within the program using an informal approach before making a formal complaint

Personnel who make a complaint in good faith will not suffer any detriment even if the grievance is not substantiated. Where personnel raise grievances that are frivolous or vexatious or any person involved gives deliberately misleading statements, they may be subject to disciplinary action

VI. Stages of Grievance Redressal

Informal Resolution Stage

Personnel are expected in the first instance to raise a matter of concern informally with their immediate supervisor, immediately or as soon as possible but within a month of the occurrence that led to the grievance. The supervisor and the complainant should make every effort to resolve the matter of concern at this stage. Within 5 working days of the complaint being raised, the supervisor is required to advise the complainant of the appropriate action to address the matter.

If the individual feels it would be inappropriate to raise the matter with his/her immediate Supervisor as it is relating to their behaviour, s/he should raise the concern with the Program/Department Head. (If the complaint relates to the Program Director's behavior, the individual should write directly to the Grievance Redressal Committee).

The supervisor will document any proposed informal resolution actions, including any deadlines by which to determine whether escalation to the formal grievance stage is necessary.

Formal Grievance Stage

If the complainant is not satisfied that his/her complaint has been resolved by informal resolution s/he may raise a formal grievance either by depositing the grievance in the „Grievance box" or by email. The procedure for raising and hearing a formal grievance is outlined below

The Grievance Redressal Committee comprising the CEO and Executive Director will review the submitted cases at the end of each month, organize hearings and witness interviews, and notify its recommendations through Program/Department Head. (The membership of the Grievance Redressal Committee is subject to future reviews).

Process

1) Personnel raises formal grievance in writing to the Grievance Redressal Committee.

   The following details should be submitted into the locked Grievance Box set up in each office.

   - Date of submission
   - Full name of the complainant
   - Designation
   - Program
   - Nature of grievance
   - Details of complaint
   - Steps taken so far

2) Respective admin checks the Grievance Boxes every month. In case there are grievances in the box, the same is opened in the presence of CEO/ED. This activity is done monthly. In case there are no grievances in the box, the admin sends an email to the CEO/ED confirming that all boxes are checked and there are no entries.

3) Complainant and respondent are notified of the hearing date within 15 working days of review by the Grievance Redressal Committee.

4) Concerned Program/Department Heads, if neither complainant nor respondent, are notified of the hearing.

5) Hearing is conducted by the Grievance Redressal Committee

6) Witnesses, if any, are interviewed by the Grievance Redressal Committee

7) The Grievance Redressal Committee notifies the decisions to Program/Department Head within 5 working days of hearing.

8) Program/Department Head notifies complainant of outcome of grievance hearing in writing and informs him/her of right to appeal to the Trustees within 5 working days

9) In cases where the grievances are anonymous, the Grievance Redressal committee will decide on the necessary action to be taken but is unable to directly communicate to the complainant. Wherever appropriate, action taken will be shared with the respective teams from where the complaint originates.

Appeals

If the complainant is not satisfied with the outcome of the grievance hearing, s/he has the right to Appeal to the Board of Trustees. The complainant should write to the Trustee focal point at ***grievance@snehamumbai.org***, indicating the following:

- Full name of the complainant
- Date on which the formal grievance was made
- Summary of the grievance
- Actions taken to date
- Reason for appeal

The supervisor who attempted the resolution in the first instance (during the informal resolution stage) should be copied on the email.

The appointed Trustee shall review the reported grievance in detail and within 30 days of appeal will recommend steps to be taken in order to resolve the case.

There is also a **"Suggestion Box"** in every team office which is reviewed monthly by the admin and reported to the Grievance committee. Action is taken as deemed appropriate. In case no suggestions are received, Admin reports the same to the CEO.

SECTION VII - SEPERATION

The following sections are covered in this Chapter:

For Employees:

A. **Resignation**

B. **Retirement**

C. **Separation on account of Permanent Disability**

D. **Death of an Employee while in Service**

E. **Termination**

For Consultants

F. **Non- renewal of contract by organization/consultant**

G. **Premature termination of Contract**

SEPERATION

I. Preamble:

The Policy on Separations lays down the guidelines and procedures for employee/consultant separations from the Organization.

The policy is based on the tenets of fairness to the employee/consultants and protection of interest of the Organization.

II. Employee Separation Categories:

A) Resignation

Resignation by an employee

B) Retirement

Retirement of the employee upon attainment of the age of **65 years**

C) Separation on account of Permanent Disability

Separation arising out of a medical condition resulting in permanent disability to the extent that the employee is declared unfit to carry out normal responsibilities at the workplace.

D) Death of an Employee while in Service

Death of an employee while the employee is still employed with SNEHA.

E) Termination

An employee's services may be terminated by the organization for any of the following reasons. The list is only indicative:

a. Non performance/poor performance of assigned duties
b. Disciplinary issues
c. Abandonment of services by an employee
d. Gross insubordination
e. Violence towards coworkers/subordinates/stakeholders
f. Using abusive/obscene language at the workplace or with stakeholders
g. Sexual harassment of coworkers/subordinates/stakeholders
h. Leaking organization data/information to competition
i. Surfing/downloading pornographic sites/contents
j. Inflaming religious sentiments
k. Inability to perform assigned duties due to medical reasons
l. Any other serious, grave misdemeanor which in the view of Management warrants termination.

Type of Separation	Salary up to Last Working Day	Notice Period	PL adjustment against Notice Period	Salary Recovery by organization/Payable by employee	Gratuity
Resignation after completion of Probation	Payable if Employee serves complete Notice Period	Employee gives 30 days' Notice from date of resignation	Can adjust balance PL against the Notice Period. Employee has to serve the balance Notice after adjusting PL.	Applicable if employee does not serve notice period. No of days not served will be recovered by the organization/payable by the employee	Payable if employee completes 5 years in the organization
Termination after completion of Probation (for reasons other than misconduct)	Payable	Organization gives 30 days from date of termination	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Payable if employee completes 5 years in the organization
Resignation while on Probation	Payable	Organization gives 7 days' notice from the date of resignation	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Payable
Termination during Probation	Payable	Organization gives 7 days' notice from the date of termination	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Payable
Retirement	Payable	Organization informs the employee 90 days prior to the retirement date.	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Payable if employee completes 5 years in the organization
Termination on account of misconduct	Payable	No Notice Required	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Payable if employee completes 5 years in the organization
Permanent Disablement	Payable	No Notice Required	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Payable if employee completes 5 years in the organization

Death	**Payable**	**Not Applicable**	**Not Applicable**	**Not Applicable**	**Payable if employee completes 5 years in the organization**

Retirement:

A. The employee is retired on the last date of the month in which he/she attains the retirement age.

B. The retiring employee is informed about his/her retirement 90 days prior to the due date of retirement.

C. A further communication is sent to the employee one month before the date of retirement, conveying the various formalities to be undergone.

Resignation Procedures for Employees:

A In case of resignation, employee submits the resignation to the supervisor on Peopleworks.

B Supervisor accepts the resignation on Peopleworks and states the last working day for the employee.

C 7 days prior to the last working day, all concerned departments receive a trigger from Peopleworks informing them about the resignation. The respective departments are required to give clearance to the employee on Peopleworks. Unless the departments give clearance on Peopleworks, employees" Full and Final settlement is not processed.

D Employee also gets a trigger on Peopleworks to complete all exit and clearance formalities on Peopleworks 7 days prior to the last working day.

E. In case of termination of employment, the request is sent to the HR Department by the concerned Program Director/Domain Head. HR completes the termination formalities and employee is exited on Peopleworks by HR.

F Exit Interviews are conducted for all resignees, and analysis of the same is presented in relevant forums. Important feedback is also shared with respective teams.

G Full and Final Settlement advice is prepared by Finance after receiving input from HR and the Full and Final cheque is prepared.

H Finance hands over the FnF cheque to the employee.

I The Experience Letter is sent to the employee post completion of Full and Final settlement.

J HR advises the Health Insurance Company for cancellation of medical insurance.

K In case of death of an employee while in service, HR advises Finance on the dues payable as per entitlement. The cheque is sent to the employees „Primary Nominee" as per the declaration signed at the time of joining.

Abandonment of services by an employee

An employee who does not return to work after the approved leave is over OR an employee who is absent from work for more than 7 continuous working days without any intimation to either the Supervisor or HR can be terminated from services of the organization.

Attempt is made by HR to connect with the employee through phone and email. Incase HR is not able to connect with the employee, HR sends 3 “show cause notices” in a gap of 7 days, each starting from the day the Supervisor intimates HR about the absence of the employee. The “show cause notice” is sent to the residential address of the employee as per HR records through speed post.

If the employee does not report to work after the deadline mentioned in the last show cause notice, HR terminates the services of the employee by sending a Termination Letter to the employee's residential address.

HR completes the exit formalities from the backend in Peopleworks, advices Finance to hold any dues payable to the employee.

Consultant Separation Categories:

A) Non-Renewal of Contract (by Organization/Consultant)

At the time of the expiry of the Contract, either the Organization or the consultant may choose not to renew the contract. This is mutually agreed between the supervisor and the consultant.

B) Premature Termination of Contract

Termination of the contract by the Organization/Consultant before the expiry of the contract. Either party is required to give 30 days" notice to the other party.

A) Termination of the Contract in case of misconduct

The consultant contract will be terminated without any notice by the organization.

SECTION VIII – POLICY ON PREVENTION OF SEXUAL HARRASMENT AT WORKPLACE

Statement of Non-tolerance

At SNEHA, we have zero-tolerance for sexual harassment. We value every single individual working at SNEHA and wish to protect their dignity. In so doing, we are determined to promote a working environment in which individuals of both sexes work, complement each other as equals in an environment that encourages maximum productivity.

Behaviour that has been defined as inappropriate by SNEHA‟s Prevention of Sexual Harassment at Workplace Policy (whether physical, verbal, written, graphic emotional or through gestures) that offend intentionally or not, and offends the dignity and morality of an individual to which the behaviour is directed by fellow employees, supervisors, vendors and suppliers will be considered sexual harassment and invite serious disciplinary action.

SNEHA‟s Prevention of Sexual Harassment at Workplace Policy covers every individual engaged with SNEHA in the capacity of either – Permanent employment, Probationer, Consultant, Individual employed through third-party vendor, Student, Trainee, Volunteers and Visitors. It is applicable to allegations made by and against employees of SNEHA working out of all locations of SNEHA, irrespective of whether sexual harassment is alleged to have taken place within or outside SNEHA premises. SNEHA encourages every employee who believes they are sexually harassed to use the Redressal Mechanism that has been laid down in this policy. We at SNEHA are committed to giving every employee a just and fair hearing on issues that are raised on sexual harassment. SNEHA will take very serious disciplinary action against any victimization of the complainant or the alleged harasser that may result from a complaint.

SNEHA‟s Prevention of Sexual Harassment at Workplace Policy has been drafted as per Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 (“POSH Act”) and rules under the POSH Act titled the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Rules, 2013 (“POSH Rules”).

Definition of Sexual Harassment

A. "Quid Pro Quo (this for that) Harassment": Sexual harassment by managers and supervisors generally is considered "quid pro quo" harassment when it involves the solicitation of sexual favors in exchange for a type of employment decision. To prove quid pro quo harassment, a complaining employee/consultant must show that he/she was subject to an unwelcome request for sexual favors by a supervisory employee and that his/her acquiescence to, or rejection of, the request was used as the basis for decisions affecting his/her compensation, terms, conditions, or other privileges of employment. Preferential treatment may also constitute quid pro quo harassment.

B. "Hostile Work Environment Harassment": Harassment by non-hierarchal employees generally falls into the category of "hostile environment" sexual harassment. Typically, there is no direct link between the offensive conduct and a tangible job benefit or detriment in hostile environment cases. An employer is responsible for hostile environment harassment by non-supervisory employees only if it is proved that the employer knew or should have known of the harassment and failed to take immediate and appropriate remedial action.

Sexual harassment is:

1. Any uninvited sexual behaviour from individuals of the same or opposite sex
2. Behaviour that offends the dignity of the individual to whom it is directed.
3. The point of consideration should be the effect that the conduct of one individual has on another individual rather than whether the behaviour was intentionally offensive or not.
4. Individuals using their positions of power to degrade and humiliate or demand sexual favours.

The following behaviour is considered inappropriate within the SNEHA working environment and is liable for disciplinary action:

Verbal Harassment:

1. A demand or request for sexual favours.
2. Comments about a person's sex or private life
3. Sexually coloured remarks

Physical Harassment

1. Offensive gestures
2. Touching in a sexual manner
3. Assault or coerced sexual acts.
4. Stalking

Written or Graphic Harassment

1. Unsolicited forwarding of pornographic pictures through email, messages or any other form of written/graphic communication tool.
2. The display of sexually suggestive objects, pictures, magazines, posters or cartoons in the work-area.
3. Written communication that has sexual implications.

The following circumstances, among other circumstances, if they occur or are present in relation to or connected with any act or behaviour of sexual harassment may amount to sexual harassment:

- Implied or explicit promise of preferential treatment in employment;
- Implied or explicit threat of detrimental treatment in employment;
- Implied or explicit threat about present or future employment status;
- Interference with work or creating an intimidating or offensive or hostile work environment; or
- humiliating treatment likely to affect the individuals' health or

safety Third Party Harassment

As per the Supreme Court Guidelines, Third Party Harassment occurs as a result of an act or omission by any third party or outsider, the employer and person in-charge will take necessary and reasonable steps to assist the affected person in terms of support and preventive action.

This case is particularly relevant in SNEHA where our employees are constantly in touch with third parties through their interaction with beneficiaries, vendors, suppliers, other NGO"s, CBO"s, Hospitals, Health Post, Police and other Government organizations, funders, guests etc.

Redressal Mechanism, Process Flow, Redressal Committee

The POSH Act requires an employer to set up an „Internal Committee" ("IC") based on certain guidelines to hear and redress grievances pertaining to sexual harassment.

In accordance with the POSH Act, SNEHA has set up an **„Internal Committee" ("IC")** comprising of the following members:

ROLE	NAME	EMAIL ADDRESS	CONTACT NUMBER	PROGRAM
PRESIDING OFFICER / CHAIRPERSON	**SUSHMA SHENDE**	**sushma@snehamumbai.org**	**9920213397**	**CHN, HCP & SC**
INTERNAL MEMBERS	SARITA PATIL	sarita@snehamumbai.org	9930456313	MNH
	UJWALA BAPAT	ujwala@snehamumbai.org	9869440222	NURSE AIDE
	GAZI SAYYED	gazi.sayed@snehamumbai.org	9892243539	IM
	POURU WADIA	pouru.wadia@snehamumbai.org	9022659532	RPC
	PRADEEP RATHOD	pradeep.rathod@snehamumbai.org	9892291531	SC
EXTERAL MEMBER	SNEHA KHANDEKAR	snehakhandekar@hotmail.com	9819770166	

Powers of the IC

The POSH Act stipulates that the Internal Committee (IC) shall, while inquiring into a complaint of workplace sexual harassment, have the same powers as vested in a civil court under the Code of Civil Procedure, 1908 when trying a suit in respect of:

- Summoning and enforcing the attendance of any person and examining him on oath;
- Requiring the discovery and production of documents; and
- Any other matter which may be prescribed.

Complaint Mechanism

1. An aggrieved individual who intends to file a complaint is required to submit six (6) copies of the written complaint, along with supporting documents and names and addresses of the witnesses to the IC or LCC, within 3 months from the date of the incident and in case of a series of incidents, within a period of 3 months from the date of the last incident.

Prompt reporting of an act of sexual harassment is probably as important as swift action to be taken by the authorities on receiving a complaint. Infact the more prompt the complaint is, the more authentic can it be treated.

2. In instances where sufficient cause is demonstrated by the complainant for the delay in filing the complaint, the IC may extend the timeline for filing the complaint, for reasons to be recorded in-writing.

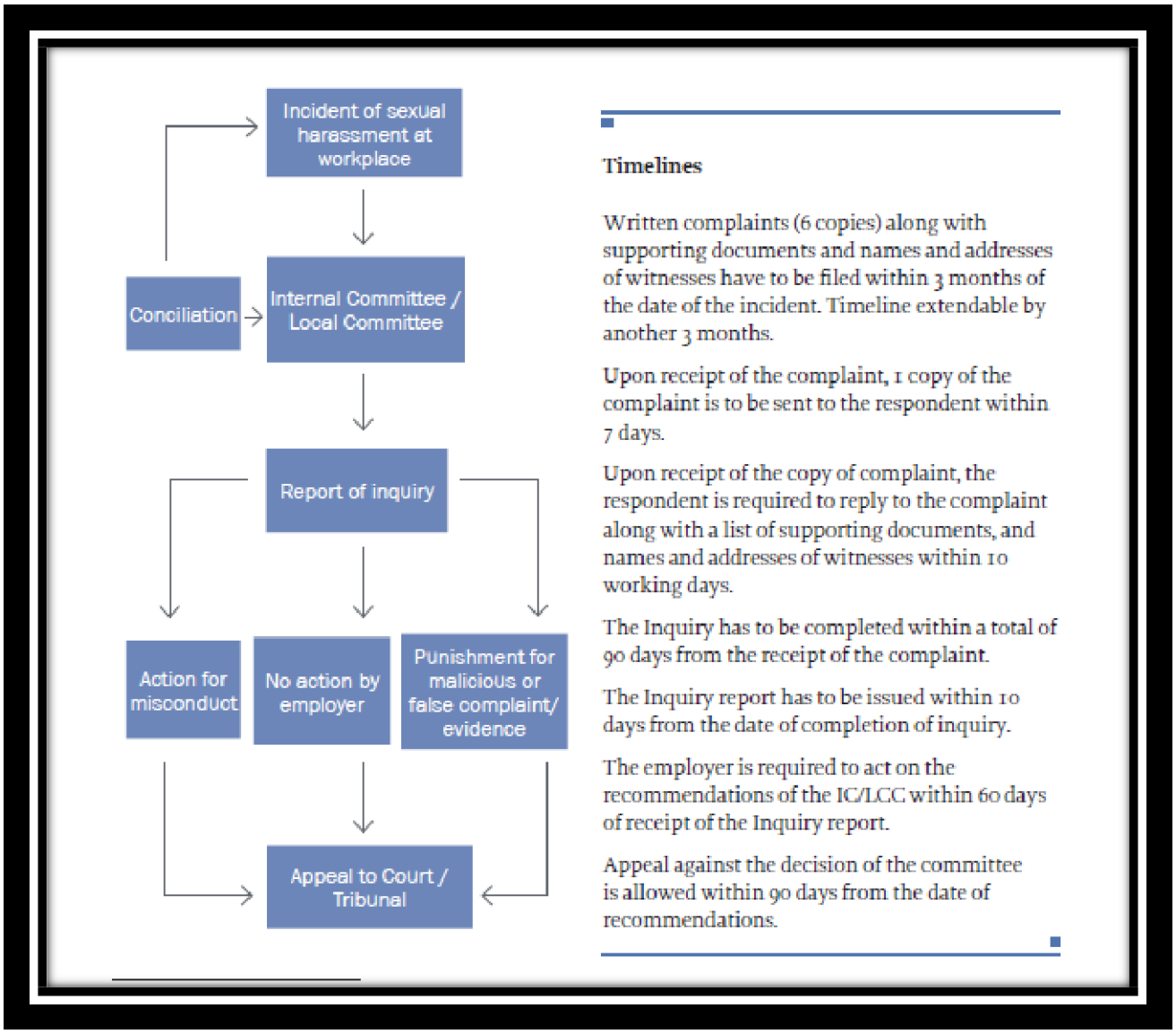
3. Friends, relatives, co-workers, psychologist & psychiatrists, etc can file the complaint in situations where the aggrieved individual is unable to make the complaint on account of physical incapacity, mental incapacity or death.

4. Given that the POSH Act and the POSH Rules do not prescribe any format in which the complaint needs to be filed, the following tips may be kept in mind:

   - The written complaint should be addressed to the IC members only.
   - The complaint should be concise, i.e. it should be written in simple language which can be understood easily.
   - Details of exact incident, date and time, witness etc. to be included.
   - Circumstances preceding and following the incident to be recorded.
   - Append as many documents as possible in whatever format i.e. relevant e-mails, screenshots of SMS"s/whatsapp messages, call details, photographs, recordings etc.
   - Details of the respondent including name, designation, reporting structure between complainant and respondent if any (whether subordinate, colleague or superior etc).
   - Do not state anything that is false or incorrect.
   - The relief that is sought from the employer.

Redressal Process/ Inquiry

Please refer to the flowchart below which provides an overview of the process to be followed by the aggrieved individual to make the complaint and by the IC to inquire into the complaint.



Complaint Handling

The Complainant shall submit to the Internal Committee, six copies of the complaint along with the supporting documents and the name and address of the witnesses. The Committee shall, within a period of seven days from the date of receipt of the same, send one copy to the Respondent.

The Respondent shall file his/her reply to the complaint along with the list of documents and the name and address of the witnesses, within a period not exceeding ten working days from the date of receipt of the documents.

The Internal Committee may, before initiating an inquiry, at the request of the Complainant may do reconciliation between her and the Respondent However, no monetary settlement shall be made the basis of the conciliation. Where a redressal has been done through conciliation, the Internal Committee shall document it and take signatures of both parties and forward the same to the management to take action as specified in the recommendation.

The Internal Committee will make all reasonable efforts to conduct inquiry thoroughly and fairly, considering protect the rights and dignity of the people involved, including the person who is believed or claimed to be harassing another. Employees who report instances of sexual harassment and all those contacted in connection with the inquiry are obliged to cooperate in the investigation and to maintain the confidentiality of the process. Failure to cooperate in an inquiry or reporting false claims may lead to discipline up to and including termination.

The Internal Committee shall proceed to make an inquiry into the complaint in accordance with the principles of natural justice and further during the course of inquiry provide an opportunity of being heard to the Complainant and the Respondent and the relevant witnesses provided by the Complainant and the Respondent.

The parties shall not be allowed to bring in any legal practitioner to represent them in their case at any stage of the proceedings before the Internal Committee. The investigation process shall be completed with a period of ninety days from date of commencement of the inquiry.

All Employees should be aware that the privacy and confidentiality of all persons involved in reporting incidents of possible Sexual Harassment and in the investigation of possible Sexual Harassment will be maintained to the extent reasonable and possible under the circumstances. In addition, the Internal Committee will take appropriate corrective action to remedy violations of this portion of the policy, up to and including termination of the Employee(s) who violate this portion of the policy.

On the completion of an inquiry, Internal the Committee will provide a report of its findings with recommendations to the management and such report will be made available to the concerned parties.

In the event that the Internal Committee arrives at the conclusion that:

(a) There is no case for Sexual Harassment, then the complaint may be dropped by the Internal Committee and shall notify the management of the same.

(b) Where the Internal Committee arrives at the conclusion that the allegation against the Respondent has been proved, it shall recommend to the management to take appropriate action, including a written apology, warning, reprimand or censure, withholding of promotion, withholding of pay rise or increments, terminating the Respondent from service or that the Respondent undergoes a counselling session or carry out community service.

If the allegation is proved to be false or malicious, action may be recommended against the Complainant as deemed fit by the Internal Committee. However, the mere inability to substantiate a complaint or provide adequate proof does not constitute grounds for taking action against the Complainant. Action can be taken against witnesses who give false evidence or produce any forged or misleading document, as recommended by the Internal Committee.

In addition to the above,

- Where there is a need for any additional facts, the IC is authorized to nominate internal or external persons to undertake fact finding or make the necessary enquiries on its behalf and report the same to the IC. The IC may also undertake any other means they deem appropriate to arrive at the facts or get information relevant to the case. This may include personal interviews with concerned employees, asking for documents or records, etc.

- The entire proceedings will be minuted by the IC and submitted to the CEO.

- Failure or refusal of any persons to co-operate, or to disturb or misguide the committee during its investigations may result in disciplinary action against such persons as deemed appropriate by the CEO.

- In the event that the conclusions of the IC are unsatisfactory to either individual, an appeal in writing can be made to the tribunal / court, by the party who is requesting the appeal within 90 days.

Interim Reliefs

At the request of the complainant, the IC may recommend to the CEO to provide interim measures such as:

1. Transfer of the aggrieved individual or the respondent to any other workplace;
2. Grant leave to the aggrieved woman up to a period of 3 months in addition to her regular statutory/ contractual leave entitlement;
3. Restrain the respondent from reporting on the work performance of the aggrieved individual.

Conciliation

Before initiating action on a complaint, the IC on the request of the aggrieved individual, can make efforts to settle the matter between the parties through conciliation by bringing about an amicable settlement. Conciliation is basically an informal method of resolving complaints before the complaint escalates into a fully blown formal inquiry. Thus, after a complaint of sexual harassment has been lodged, the aggrieved individual may request the IC to resolve the matter by conciliating between the parties before commencement of the inquiry proceedings. Once the settlement has been arrived at, the IC shall record the settlement arrived at and thereafter provide copies of the settlement to the aggrieved individual as well as the respondent. Incase a settlement cannot be arrived; the IC shall proceed with an inquiry under the POSH Act.

Disciplinary Action

The nature and severity of disciplinary action against the guilty will be in direct proportion to the seriousness of the offence. This could range from but will not be limited to:

1. A letter of warning that will be placed in the personal file.
2. Immediate transfer or suspension without pay or both.
3. Dismissal/ termination from the services of SNEHA.
4. Withholding of promotion, increments or both
5. Undergoing counseling
6. Any other disciplinary action that the committee may deem fit.

Frivolous complaints

If the IC concludes that the allegation made by the complainant is false or malicious or the complaint has been made knowing it to be untrue or forged or misleading information has been provided during the inquiry, disciplinary action in accordance with the above can be taken against such complainant.

Confidentiality

Recognising the sensitivity attached to matters pertaining to sexual harassment, SNEHA attaches significant importance to ensuring that the complaint and connected information is kept confidential. The POSH Act specifically stipulates that information pertaining to workplace sexual harassment shall not be subject to the provisions of the Right to Information Act, 2005. Individuals involved in the complaints process/inquiry/redressal should refrain from divulging the details of complaint / any information gathered by them in the course of the inquiry and the identities of the persons involved should not be disclosed. Any breach of confidentiality will be taken seriously and will attract disciplinary action in accordance with the above.

Annexure 1: Examples of Conduct Amounting to Sexual Harassment

Whether an act or conduct would amount to „sexual harassment" is dependent on the specifics of the act and the circumstances. The following is an indicative list of conduct that could be considered as sexual harassment:

Unwanted sexual advances or propositions;	Eve-teasing;
Pestering for dates or receiving unwelcome sexual suggestions or invitations;	Sexually tinted remarks, whistling, staring,
Offering employment benefits in exchange for sexual favours;	sexually slanted and obscene jokes, jokes
Leering;	causing or likely to cause awkwardness or embarrassment;
Making sexual gestures;	Subtle innuendoes or open taunting regarding perfection, imperfection or characteristics of physical appearance of a person's body or shape;
Displaying sexually suggestive objects or pictures, cartoons, calendars or posters;	Gender based insults and/or sexist remarks
Making or using derogatory comments, comments about a person's body or dress, slurs, epithets or sexually suggestive jokes;	Displaying pornographic or other sexually offensive or derogatory material;
Written communications of a sexual nature distributed in hard copy or via a computer network, suggestive or obscene letters, notes or invitations;	Forcible invitations for dates;
Physical conduct such as unwanted touching, assault, impeding or blocking movements;	Forcible physical touch or physical assault or molestation;
Being forcibly kissed or hugged;	Suggesting or implying that failure to accept a request for a date or sexual favours would adversely affect the individual in respect to performance evaluation or promotion;
Having someone expose their private parts to you or repeatedly staring at a woman's body parts that makes her uncomfortable;	Explicitly or implicitly suggesting sexual favours in return for hiring, compensation, promotion, retention decision, relocation, or allocation of job/responsibility/work;
Making or threatening retaliation after a negative response to sexual advances or for reporting or threatening to report sexual harassment;	Physical confinement against one's will and any other act likely to violate one's privacy.
Any act or conduct by a person in authority and belonging to one sex which denies or would deny equal opportunity in pursuit of career development or otherwise making the environment at the work place hostile or intimidating to a person belonging to the other sex, only on the ground of such individual providing or refusing sexual favours;	

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